

COMPLETE LEARNING SESSION

LATER WITTGENSTEIN - Layered Complete Learning Session - Philosophy Paper I Western Philosophy 08

UPSC complete learning session | Foundation to advanced | Concepts, evidence, practice and answer writing

PHILOSOPHY PAPER I | WESTERN PHILOSOPHY 08

LATER WITTGENSTEIN

From picturing facts to meaning as use: language-games, forms of life, and the dissolution of philosophical problems.

THE TURN - one thinker, two pictures of meaning



THREE PILLARS OF THE LATER PHILOSOPHY



meaning lives in public, criterion-governed practice - not in a private inner object



"Don't think, but look": describe use, assemble a perspicuous view

- and philosophy "leaves everything as it is" (PI 124).

Meaning as use, grounded in forms of life; the private-language argument dissolves the Cartesian inner; philosophy becomes therapy, not theory.

Owens exactly 7 Western Philosophy PYQ parts, 2018-2025 - one each year except 2021.

Original deterministic study visual; labels are explanatory, not textual quotations.

Source order: repository knowledge -> official current linkage -> clearly marked analysis. No fabricated PYQs or statistics.

LATER WITTGENSTEIN - Layered Complete Learning Session - Philosophy Paper I Western Philosophy 08

Syllabus: Later Wittgenstein - Meaning and Use; Language-games; Forms of Life; Rule-following; the Critique of Private Language; Criteria and Symptoms; Philosophy as Therapy; Aspect-seeing.

How to Use This Five-Layer Session

Every logical subtopic follows exactly:

Layer	Purpose
1. SIMPLE START	visual-first plain-language gateway
2. CORE UPSC	complete terminology, doctrine, argument, example and PI-section grounding
3. ADVANCED	objections, replies, comparisons, interpretive issues and provenance cautions
4. EXAM APPLICATION	verified PYQ routes and 10/15/20-mark architecture
5. RAPID REVISION	traps, retrieval notes and links to the exact MCQ set

Source Audit and Contemporary-Link Boundary

- Canonical doctrine source:

upsc-ai-kit/knowledge/Philosophy/paper-1/western/Later-Wittgenstein.md (8,153 words), sliced verbatim into every CORE UPSC layer and preserved again in the canonical apparatus block. - **Verified PYQs:** continuous local Western Philosophy Paper I bank, 2018-2025; this clause owns exactly **7** primary parts, one each in 2018, 2019, 2020, 2022, 2023, 2024 and 2025. **2021 is the only year without an owned part.**

- **Ownership discipline:** early-Wittgenstein (*Tractatus*) parts and Logical Positivism parts are owned by their own clauses and appear here only as labelled comparisons; none is counted among the 7. - **Printed anomalies preserved verbatim:** the 2022 Q1(c) official English line prints "**motion** of language" (a slip for "notion"), and the 2025 Q3(a) statement retains an **unmatched opening quotation** before "logical structure". Both are reproduced exactly and explained, never silently corrected. - **Provenance discipline:** the *Philosophical Investigations* was published **posthumously in 1953** (Wittgenstein died 1951), edited by G. E. M. Anscombe and Rush Rhees, Anscombe translating; the *Tractatus* is 1921/1922. The duck-rabbit belongs to **PI Part II xi / PPF** and to Jastrow; "Kripkenstein" is a labelled reading, not Wittgenstein's own doctrine. - **Qdrant:** optional fallback only; not required for this canonical topic. - **Contemporary link (deliberately not forced):** a live search across 2026-02-19 to 2026-08-19 produced no sufficiently direct, well-verified official or academic development to anchor this clause, and no AI/LLM blog item is promoted to a current-affairs anchor. The honest contemporary relevance is static and disciplinary: meaning-as-use, criteria and forms of life underwrite present-day **philosophy of language and mind** (pragmatics, use-based and inferential semantics, the philosophy of psychology), which is why the clause is examined almost every year. That is stated as analysis, not as a dated news event.

Preservation note: the canonical doctrine is reorganised into layers, never compressed. Every doctrine, canonical quotation, numbered argument, PI-section citation, objection/reply, comparison, restored dossier, corpus-depth delta, PYQ route, directive rule, graded verdict and provenance caution is retained; simplification means adding accessible gateways, not deleting complexity.

Learning Roadmap

Unit	Logical subtopic
1	The Break from the Tractatus - Placement, the One-Screen Map and Why the Later Philosophy Begins
2	Meaning as Use - the Toolbox, the PI 43 Qualification and Mastery of a Technique
3	Family Resemblance - Overlapping Similarities, Fuzzy Boundaries and 'Don't Think, But Look'
4	Language-Games - Language Woven into Activity, the Builders and Rules by Training
5	Forms of Life - PI 19, Agreement in Form of Life, the Lion Remark and the Bedrock of Justification
6	Rule-Following and the Paradox (PI 201) - Interpretation Regress, Practice and Going On
7	The Private-Language Argument - Logical Privacy, the Diary 'S', the Beetle and Public Criteria
8	Criteria vs Symptoms, PI 580 Outward Criteria and the Behaviourism Charge Answered
9	Philosophy as Therapy - Language on Holiday, the Fly-Bottle, Perspicuous Representation and 'Leaves Everything as It Is'
10	Aspect-Seeing and the Duck-Rabbit - Seeing-As, the Dawning of an Aspect and Aspect-Blindness

Progress: 1 / 10 | Philosophy Layered Session | Subtopic: The Break from the Tractatus - Placement, the One-Screen Map and Why the Later Philosophy Begins

LAYER 1 - SIMPLE START

Visual gateway - one thinker, two philosophies

THE SAME MAN, TWO PICTURES OF MEANING

EARLY (Tractatus, 1921)	LATER (Investigations, 1953)
Meaning = PICTURING facts	Meaning = USE in a form of life
ONE hidden essence (logical form)	NO essence - FAMILY RESEMBLANCE
Name -> Object (fixed reference)	Countless LANGUAGE-GAMES
Build an IDEAL logical language	Ordinary language is in order
Private inner reference is fine	PRIVATE LANGUAGE is impossible
Philosophy = draw limits; be silent about the rest	Philosophy = THERAPY: dissolve knots made by language idling

Caption: read the two columns as a before/after. Everything in this syllabus item is the right-hand column reacting against the left.

Plain-language start: The young Wittgenstein thought a sentence is meaningful because it is a *picture* of a possible fact - words hook onto objects, and the sentence models reality the way a scale-model models a car crash. That is the *Tractatus*. Decades later he decided this was a beautiful mistake. Real language is not one machine that pictures; it is a huge kit of different tools used in different activities - ordering, joking, praying, measuring, greeting. So meaning is not "what a word pictures" but "what people *do* with the word." The later philosophy is the working-out of that one change, and the exam rewards you for tracing it precisely.

Idea	Plain meaning
Picture theory	a sentence means by mirroring a possible fact
Use theory	a word means by its role in a shared activity
Augustinian picture	the tempting idea that every word names an object
Colour-exclusion problem	"this spot is red" and "this spot is green" cannot both be true, yet the Tractatus said elementary propositions are independent - a crack Wittgenstein himself found in 1929

Idea	Plain meaning
Description, not theory	philosophy should describe how language works, not build a rival theory of meaning

MEMORY: **Mnemonic - "PEIPS -> UFLOT"**: the early Picture / Essence / Ideal-language / Private-reference / Silence flips into later Use / Family-resemblance / Language-games / Ordinary-language / Therapy.

LAYER 2 - CORE UPSC

Placement: The *second* Wittgenstein (*Philosophical Investigations*, 1953) revises the earlier *Tractatus*. Meaning is no longer exhausted by picturing; it is **use in a form of life**. This owner carries 7 parts in 2018–2025, with no primary-owned part in 2021; family resemblance and private language are the restored-year additions.

0. ONE-SCREEN MAP ANALYSIS:

EARLY (<i>Tractatus</i> , 1921)	LATER (<i>Investigations</i> , 1953)
Meaning = PICTURING facts	Meaning = USE in a form of life
One essence of language (logical form)	NO single essence – FAMILY RESEMBLANCE
Name -> Object (fixed reference)	Countless LANGUAGE-GAMES
Ideal logical language	Ordinary language is perfectly in order
Private inner reference unproblematic	PRIVATE LANGUAGE impossible
Philosophy = draw limits of the sayable; "be silent" about the rest	Philosophy = THERAPY (dissolve knots created by language "on holiday")
Key terms: use · language-game · form of life · family resemblance · rule-following · private language · beetle-in-a-box · therapeutic conception	

MEMORY: **Mnemonic — "U-G-F"**: Meaning is **Use**; uses are organised as language-**G**ames; games are grounded in **F**orms of life.

1. THE BREAK FROM THE TRACTATUS — AND WHY (PYQ 2025 Q3(a), 2023 Q4(c))

1.1 What Changed FACT:

Tractatus assumption	Later Wittgenstein's rejection	Reason
Language has ONE essence — picturing facts via shared logical form	Language has NO single essence; there are indefinitely many language-games, each with its own "grammar"	"Don't think, but LOOK" — when we actually examine how language is used, we find irreducible diversity
Meaning = the possible state of affairs a proposition pictures	Meaning = use in the language	The word "game" does not picture a single thing; its meaning is its varied use across contexts
An ideal logical language underlies ordinary language	Ordinary language is <i>perfectly in order as it is</i> — no need for an ideal language behind it	Philosophical problems arise not from deficient language but from <i>misunderstanding</i> the workings of our language
Elementary propositions are logically independent	Colour-exclusion problem: "This spot is red" and "This spot is green" are elementary yet logically incompatible — the <i>Tractatus</i> cannot account for this	This was one of the first cracks Wittgenstein himself noticed (1929)
Names get meaning by standing for objects	Names get meaning through their role in language-games — training, context, use	The "Augustinian picture of language" is at best one primitive language-game, not the essence of all meaning

1.2 The Transition Quoted (2025 Q3(a))

ANALYSIS: The 2025 question quotes (in substance): "We should look not to an ideal language which derives its meaning from facts and has a precise logical structure but empirically, to the ways in which languages are actually used."

This captures the shift: from a **top-down logical theory** of meaning (the *Tractatus*) to a **bottom-up descriptive investigation** of actual linguistic practice (the *Investigations*). The later Wittgenstein does not construct a rival *theory* of meaning — he refuses the very demand for a theory. Philosophy's role is now *description*, not explanation.

LAYER 3 - ADVANCED

The reasons for the shift - keep them ordered and named

Examiners in 2023 and 2025 ask *why* the shift happened. Give internal reasons, not biography:

- **The colour-exclusion problem (1929).** The *Tractatus* held elementary propositions to be logically independent, yet "a is red all over" excludes "a is green all over". Wittgenstein could not repair this within the old system; it was the first structural crack he himself noticed.
- **The Augustinian picture is too narrow.** Naming-an-object works for "table" but collapses for "the", "if", "five", "pain", "meaning", "perhaps". If one model cannot cover these, meaning cannot be *one* thing.
- **The demand for an ideal language is misdiagnosis.** Philosophical problems do not come from a defective surface language hiding a perfect logical one; they come from *misunderstanding* the ordinary language we already have. So "ordinary language is in order as it is."
- **From theory to description.** The deepest reason is methodological: the later Wittgenstein refuses to offer a rival *theory* of meaning at all. "Don't think, but look" replaces "posit the hidden essence".

ANALYSIS: the strongest answers present the break as *self-criticism from inside*, not as a fashion. The colour-exclusion crack is the empirical wedge; the Augustinian critique is the semantic wedge; the "ordinary language is in order" thesis is the methodological pay-off. State all three and you have the body of the 2023 answer already.

Provenance caution (worth a mark): the *Investigations* was published *posthumously in 1953* (Wittgenstein died 1951), edited by G. E. M. Anscombe and Rush Rhees, Anscombe translating. Never write "Wittgenstein published the *Investigations*". The *Tractatus* is 1921 (German) / 1922 (English).

LAYER 4 - EXAM APPLICATION

How the break itself is examined

- **2023 Q4(c), 15 marks** asks directly for the *main reasons* Wittgenstein shifted from the picture-theory to the use-theory. Structure: name the two theories -> colour-exclusion crack -> Augustinian critique -> "ordinary language in order" -> description-not-theory -> one line of assessment (the shift trades system for faithfulness to practice).
- **2025 Q3(a), 20 marks** quotes the transition itself and asks you to *explain the transition* with reference to the statement. Open by placing the quotation as the hinge from a top-down logical theory to a bottom-up description of actual use.
- **Placement facts that must be right:** *Tractatus* 1921; *Investigations* 1953 (posthumous, Anscombe/Rhees). This owner carries 7 parts in 2018-2025, with **none in 2021**.

10-mark use: two columns of the map, plus the single reason the question targets. **15/20-mark use:** map -> the ordered reasons -> the methodological pay-off (therapy, §5A) -> a verdict that the later view is more faithful but renounces the ambition of a theory.

for "the," "if," "five," "pain," "meaning," "perhaps." Words are **tools in a toolbox** — they have diverse functions, not one (reference). FACT:

2. **Understanding = mastery of a technique:** To understand a word is not to have a private mental image or "aha" experience. It is to be able to *go on* using it correctly — a practical ability, publicly demonstrable. FACT:
3. **Context-dependence:** Meaning is not fixed in isolation; it depends on the language-game in which the word is being used. The word "Water!" means different things shouted in a fire, requested at a table, or noted on a chemistry board. FACT:

LAYER 3 - ADVANCED

The three moves - and the one qualification you must quote

- **Move 1: reject the referential / Augustinian picture.** Not every word names an object. "The", "if", "five", "meaning", "perhaps" have no object; even "table" is understood by using it, not by an inner ceremony of reference. Words are "tools in a toolbox" with diverse functions. - **Move 2: understanding is mastery of a technique.** To understand a word is to be able to *go on* using it correctly - a public, demonstrable ability, not a private mental episode. This quietly pre-loads the private-language argument (subtopic 7): if understanding were a private inner state, no one could check it, and "correct use" would lose its meaning.
- **Move 3: meaning is context-dependent.** "Water!" shouted at a fire, asked at a table, or written on a chemistry board does different work. Meaning lives in the language-game, not in the word taken neat.

ANALYSIS: the single most examiner-pleasing sentence here is the PI 43 hedge - **"For a large class of cases - though not for all - in which we employ the word 'meaning' it can be defined thus: the meaning of a word is its use in the language."** Reproducing the qualification shows that Wittgenstein is *describing a large family of uses*, not legislating a new dogma "all meaning is use". Answers that flatten section 43 into "meaning IS use, full stop" mis-state the text and lose the mark.

Caution: "use theory" is a helpful label but Wittgenstein resists calling it a *theory* of meaning; it is a reminder of how the word "meaning" itself is used. Keep the anti-theory posture from subtopic 1 in view.

LAYER 4 - EXAM APPLICATION

Verified routes and answer architecture

- **2023 Q4(c), 15 marks** turns on this subtopic: the *use-theory* is the destination of the shift from the picture-theory. Give the toolbox, the technique-mastery point and the section 43 qualification, then assess.
- **2025 Q3(a), 20 marks** needs the use-theory as the "later view" the transition arrives at; quote the "ways in which languages are actually used" line and connect it to "meaning is use in the language". - **Directive care:** "critically discuss" (2023) demands one line of assessment - typically that the account is faithful to practice but hard to pin down precisely (what counts as "the" use?), which is why it invites the family-resemblance treatment next.

15-mark spine: referential picture rejected -> toolbox -> understanding = technique -> section 43 qualification -> context-dependence -> verdict. **Contemporary honesty:** no forced 2026 news anchor; the standing relevance is that "meaning as use" underwrites present-day pragmatics and use-based theories of language, stated as analysis.

LAYER 5 - RAPID REVISION

Rapid recall

- Thesis (PI 43): **the meaning of a word is its use in the language** - "for a large class of cases - **though not for all**" (quote the hedge). - Words are **tools in a toolbox**: ask the job, not the object. "The", "if", "five", "pain" have no object. - **Understanding = mastery of a technique** = being able to *go on* correctly; a public ability, not a private image.
- Meaning is **context-dependent** - fixed by the language-game ("Water!"). - **Trap**: flattening section 43 into "all meaning is use"; treating use-theory as a new *theory* Wittgenstein endorses.
- **Practice link**: MCQs 4-6; PYQs 2023 Q4(c), 2025 Q3(a).

Progress: 3 / 10 | Philosophy Layered Session | Subtopic: Family Resemblance - Overlapping Similarities, Fuzzy Boundaries and 'Don't Think, But Look'

LAYER 1 - SIMPLE START

Visual gateway - the family web

```
WHAT DO ALL "GAMES" SHARE? -> no single thread
board  card  ball  Olympic  solitaire  war-
games  games  games  games      (no winner) games
  \      |      |      |      |      /
  \      |      |      |      |      /
  +-----+-----+-----+-----+
                SIMILARITIES
  (skill? luck? winning? fun? rules?)
each pair shares SOMETHING; NO feature is common to ALL
just like a family: the nose here, the gait there, the
temperament somewhere else - a resemblance, not an essence
```

Caption: concepts can be held together by a web of overlapping likenesses, with no core property running through every case.

Plain-language start: Ask "what do all games have in common?" You will fail - some have winners, some do not; some need skill, some luck; some are solitary, some social. Yet "game" is a perfectly good word. Wittgenstein's picture: the cases are related like members of a family - overlapping and criss-crossing resemblances, not one shared essence. And the method that reveals this is not armchair theorising but "Don't think, but look!" - actually inspect the cases.

Term	Plain meaning
Family resemblance	a network of overlapping similarities, no single common feature
Fuzzy boundary	a concept can lack sharp edges and still work
"Don't think, but look"	inspect actual uses instead of demanding a definition

MEMORY: **Mnemonic - "NO CORE":** Network Of Criss-crossing Overlapping Resemblances, no Essence.

LAYER 2 - CORE UPSC

2.2 Family Resemblance FACT:

FACT: *"Don't think, but look!"*

Consider "game" — board-games, ball-games, card-games, the Olympic games, war-games, language-games. Is there one thing they all share? No. There is *"a complicated network of similarities overlapping and criss-crossing: sometimes overall similarities, sometimes similarities of detail."* Like the features running through a family — one member has the nose, another the gait, a third the temperament — no single feature is common to all. FACT:

Philosophical consequence: Concepts need not have sharp boundaries. Definitions with necessary and sufficient conditions (the Socratic demand; the *Tractatus*'s demand for a single logical form) are not always possible — and that is *fine*. Language works perfectly well with fuzzy-edged concepts.

2.3 "Don't Think, But Look" — The Method ANALYSIS:

The later Wittgenstein's method is **descriptive, not explanatory**:

- Do not ask "What *must* meaning be?" — look at how words *are* used. - Do not seek the hidden *essence* behind varied uses — describe the *variety*. - When puzzled about a concept (knowledge, time, consciousness), assemble *reminders* of how we actually use the word in various language-games — the puzzlement dissolves.

LAYER 3 - ADVANCED

Why this is a weapon, not a curiosity

- **It kills the Socratic/Tractarian demand for essences.** Since Plato, philosophy assumed a real definition (necessary and sufficient conditions) hides behind every general word. Family resemblance says: not always, and that is *fine* - "game", "language", "number", "understanding" work without one. This directly dissolves a whole genre of "what is X really?" questions.
- **Fuzzy boundaries are a feature.** A concept with blurred edges is not defective; "is a photograph a picture?" has no forced answer, and the language runs perfectly. Demanding sharpness everywhere is the mistake, not the blur.
- **"Don't think, but look" is the method in miniature.** It tells you to *describe the variety* of uses rather than *posit* a hidden unity. This is the anti-essentialism that powers the treatment of "language" itself: there is no single essence of language, only many language-games (subtopic 4).

ANALYSIS: the 2018 question ties family resemblance to "language is a game". The link is exact: because "game" has no essence, the analogy "language is a game" does not smuggle in a hidden essence of language either - it *frees* us from the search for one. Family resemblance is thus not a side-topic but the logical bridge from "meaning as use" to "language-games".

Caution: family resemblance is *not* the claim that games share a vague "something"; it is the stronger claim that there is *no single feature* common to all - only overlapping likenesses. Writing "they all share family resemblance" as if that were the common property inverts the point.

LAYER 4 - EXAM APPLICATION

Verified routes and answer architecture

- **2018 Q1(c), 10 marks** is the owner: *how does the notion of "family resemblance" help Wittgenstein to uphold that "Language is a game"?* Structure: define family resemblance (no common essence, overlapping similarities, the games example) -> show that "language" likewise has no essence -> therefore "language is a game" is not a metaphor hiding an essence but a release from essence-hunting -> close with "Don't think, but look".
- **Cross-links:** feeds 2023 Q4(c) (the shift away from a single essence of meaning) and 2022 Q1(c) (forms of life as the ground of the many games). - **Directive care:** "Discuss" at 10 marks wants the mechanism (why the analogy works), not just a definition.

10-mark spine: games example -> overlapping/criss-crossing similarities -> no common essence -> so "language is a game" -> "don't think, but look".

LAYER 5 - RAPID REVISION

Rapid recall

- **Games** share no single feature - only "a complicated network of similarities overlapping and criss-crossing". Model: a **family** (nose, gait, temperament). - Consequence: **concepts need not have sharp boundaries**; definitions by necessary-and-sufficient conditions are not always possible - and that is fine. - Method: **"Don't think, but look!"** - describe the variety, do not posit an essence. - **Bridge**: because "game" has no essence, "language is a game" does not smuggle one in - it dissolves the search. (2018 link.) - **Trap**: treating "family resemblance" as itself the shared property; demanding sharp edges. - **Practice link**: MCQs 7-9; PYQ 2018 Q1(c).

Progress: 4 / 10 | Philosophy Layered Session | Subtopic: Language-Games - Language Woven into Activity, the Builders and Rules by Training

LAYER 1 - SIMPLE START

Visual gateway - the language-game ecosystem

```
LANGUAGE = language + the ACTIVITIES it is woven into
+-----+
| ordering | describing | reporting | joking | thanking |
| greeting | praying   | guessing  | story  | requesting |
+-----+
      not ONE calculus - COUNTLESS games,
      each with its own rules and purpose
      |
      THE BUILDERS: A calls "Slab!" -> B brings a slab
      a COMPLETE primitive language, not a broken bit of ours
```

Caption: language is less like one master-machine and more like a whole marketplace of small, self-contained practices.

Plain-language start: A "language-game" (*Sprachspiel*) is the whole package of *words plus the activity they belong to*. When a builder shouts "Slab!" and his mate brings a slab, that tiny exchange is a complete language - it does its job, and it does not need logical form or picturing to be meaningful. It needs a *role in a shared practice*. And you learn such games the way you learn any craft: by *training* - being drilled, shown examples, corrected - not by decoding a hidden calculus.

Term	Plain meaning
Language-game (<i>Sprachspiel</i>)	language + the activity into which it is woven
The builders' example	"Slab!" - a complete, self-contained primitive language
Rules by training	rules learned by drill, example and correction, not by grasping an essence
Living language	new games are born, old ones die; language evolves

MEMORY: **Mnemonic - "WEAVE"**: Words Embedded in Activity; games are learned, Varied and Evolving.

LAYER 2 - CORE UPSC

3. LANGUAGE-GAMES FACT:

3.1 Definition FACT:

A **language-game** (*Sprachspiel*) = the whole consisting of language **and the activities into which it is woven**. Language is not a single, uniform calculus but **countless different games** — each with its own rules and purposes:

FACT: Giving orders · describing · reporting · speculating · forming hypotheses · presenting results · telling jokes · making up a story · play-acting · singing · guessing riddles · making a request · thanking · cursing · greeting · praying...

3.2 The Builders' Example FACT:

Imagine two builders: A shouts "Slab!" and B brings a slab; "Block!" — a block; "Pillar!" — a pillar. This is a **complete** primitive language — fully functional for its purpose. It is not a deficient version of our language; it is a self-contained language-game. Language does not *need* logical form or picturing to be meaningful — it needs a role in a shared practice. FACT:

3.3 Rules and Training FACT:

Language-games are **rule-governed** — but rules are learned by *training* (drill, example, correction), not by grasping a Platonic essence or decoding a hidden calculus. New games arise and old ones die; language is *living* and *evolving*.

LAYER 3 - ADVANCED

The load-bearing claims

- **Definition matters.** A language-game is not a metaphor for "conversation". It is the technical unit of the later philosophy: the *whole* of language-and-activity. Meaning is what a word does *inside* such a whole.
- **The builders show completeness.** The "Slab!/Block!/Pillar!" language is not a defective fragment of English; it is a self-contained language for its purpose. This detonates the *Tractatus* assumption that all meaningful language must share one logical form. If a four-word practice is already a complete language, there is no universal form that meaning must take.
- **Rules are grounded in training, not Platonism.** We are drilled into the games as children; correctness is a matter of shared practice, not of matching a hidden calculus. This sets up rule-following (subtopic 6): the "rules" of a game cannot be a further set of rules all the way down - at some point there is just what we are trained to do. - **Plurality and change.** There is no fixed list of games; they arise and lapse. Language is "living".

ANALYSIS: keep the entailment chain visible - **many games -> no single essence of language (family resemblance) -> rules rest on training/practice -> practice rests on forms of life (subtopic 5)**. Each link is a separate exam prompt, but the strongest answers show them as one descent from surface variety to bedrock practice.

Caution: do not confuse a language-game with a "game" in the ordinary sense; the point of the word is the *rule-governed, trained, purposive* character shared with games, not amusement.

LAYER 4 - EXAM APPLICATION

Verified routes and answer architecture

- **2018 Q1(c), 10 marks** ("Language is a game") is answered *through* this subtopic plus family resemblance: the many language-games are exactly why "language" has no essence.
 - **2022 Q1(c), 10 marks** (form of life) builds on it: the games are grounded in shared forms of life. - **Builders' example** is the single most efficient illustration for any question that asks why meaning does not require picturing or logical form - deploy it in one sentence. - **Directive care:** if asked to "establish" or "discuss", define the unit first (language + activity), then use the builders as proof of completeness.
- 10-mark spine:** definition (language + activity) -> the builders (a complete primitive language) -> plurality of games -> rules by training -> living/evolving language.

LAYER 5 - RAPID REVISION

Rapid recall

- **Language-game (Sprachspiel)** = language + the activities into which it is woven; **countless** games, each with its own rules/purpose. - **Builders' example:** "Slab!" -> brings a slab; a **complete** primitive language, not a broken bit of ours - meaning needs a *role in a practice*, not logical form.
- **Rules by training** (drill, example, correction), not by grasping a Platonic essence or hidden calculus. - Language is **living**: games are born and die. - **Chain:** many games -> no essence (family resemblance) -> rules by practice -> forms of life. - **Practice link:** MCQs 10-12; PYQs 2018 Q1(c), 2022 Q1(c).

Progress: 5 / 10 | Philosophy Layered Session | Subtopic: Forms of Life - PI 19, Agreement in Form of Life, the Lion Remark and the Bedrock of Justification

LAYER 1 - SIMPLE START

Visual gateway - digging down to bedrock

```
WHY DO YOU FOLLOW THIS RULE? keep asking "why?"...
rule -> because of another rule -> because... ->
-----
| spade turns: "This is simply what I do." |
| BEDROCK = FORM OF LIFE |
| shared human practices, reactions, activities |
-----
agreement in LANGUAGE = agreement in FORM OF LIFE,
                        NOT agreement in OPINION
"If a lion could talk, we could not understand him."
```

Caption: justification does not go on forever; it ends in what we shared-ly *do*.

Plain-language start: Under the language-games lies something even more basic: *forms of life* (Lebensform) - the shared human ways of acting, reacting and living that make the games possible. When you ask "why follow the rule this way?" the chain of reasons runs out, and all that is left is "this is simply what I do." That is not a failure of justification; it is where justification *rests*. And note what "agreement" means here: we agree not by holding the same *opinions* but by sharing a *form of life*. Wittgenstein's vivid test: even if a lion spoke, we could not understand him - his natural history is too unlike ours for the words to connect.

Term	Plain meaning
Form of life (Lebensform)	shared human practices, reactions and activities
Agreement in form of life	shared ways of acting, not shared opinions
The lion remark	too different a form of life breaks understanding
Bedrock	"This is simply what I do" - justification ends in practice

MEMORY: **Mnemonic - "BAR"**: Bedrock is practice; Agreement is in form of life not opinion; Reasons run out at "what I do".

LAYER 2 - CORE UPSC

3.4 Forms of Life (Lebensform) FACT: (PYQ 2022 Q1(c))

FACT: "To imagine a language means to imagine a form of life." (Investigations §19)

Language-games rest on shared human **practices, activities, and natural reactions** — what Wittgenstein calls *forms of life*. Agreement in language is not agreement in *opinions* but agreement **in form of life** — shared ways of acting, reacting, judging.

FACT: "If a lion could talk, we could not understand him." — because his form of life (his natural history, reactions, activities) would be so different from ours that the words would not connect to anything we share.

Justification ends in form of life: Why do we follow *this* rule? Ultimately: "This is simply what I do." There is no further ground beneath shared practice. FACT:

LAYER 3 - ADVANCED

The claims that carry the marks

- **PI 19: "To imagine a language means to imagine a form of life."** A language is not free-floating; it is inseparable from a mode of living. This is the exact sentence the 2022 question is built on. - **Agreement in form of life, not in opinion.** Wittgenstein: humans "agree in the language they use... this is agreement not in opinions but in form of life." This blocks a relativist misreading (it is not "we just happen to vote the same") and an intellectualist one (it is not "we all believe the same theory"). It is shared *doing*.
- **The lion remark.** "If a lion could talk, we could not understand him" - because his form of life (reactions, activities, natural history) is so different that the words would not link to anything we share. Meaning presupposes a shared background, not just a shared vocabulary. - **Justification ends in practice.** "This is simply what I do" - there is no further ground beneath shared practice. This is the terminus of the rule-following considerations (subtopic 6) and the ground of the anti-private-language argument (subtopic 7).

ANALYSIS: "form of life" is Wittgenstein's anti-foundationalist bedrock, and it is easy to over-read. It does *not* license cultural relativism ("anything goes if your culture does it"), because the shared background is largely *natural* (common reactions, the human body, primitive responses), not merely conventional. The exam-safe formulation: forms of life are the *given* - "what has to be accepted, the given, is - so one could say - forms of life."

Caution: the term appears rarely in the text but bears huge weight; do not inflate it into a full social theory. Keep it as the *bedrock where explanation stops*.

LAYER 4 - EXAM APPLICATION

Verified routes and answer architecture

- **2022 Q1(c), 10 marks** is the owner and carries a printed anomaly: "Establish the *tenability* of later Wittgenstein's *motion* of language as form of life." The official English line prints "**motion**", not "notion" - preserve it verbatim and note it, then answer the intended "notion of language as form of life". - **Structure:** PI 19 -> agreement in form of life not opinion -> the lion remark -> "this is simply what I do" -> assess tenability (strength: explains why justification stops and why understanding needs shared background; worry: the notion is under-defined and risks either triviality or relativism). - **Cross-links:** grounds language-games (subtopic 4) and rule-following (subtopic 6); comparison anchor for the 2019/2024 private-language questions (a private form of life is no form of life).

10-mark spine: PI 19 -> agreement in form of life -> lion -> bedrock -> one line on tenability.

LAYER 5 - RAPID REVISION

Rapid recall

- **PI 19:** "To imagine a language means to imagine a **form of life**." (Lebensform) - **Agreement in form of life, not in opinion** - shared *doing*, not shared beliefs; blocks both relativist and intellectualist misreadings.
- **Lion remark:** too different a form of life -> no understanding, even with speech. - **Bedrock:** "This is simply what I do" - justification ends in practice; forms of life are "the given". - **2022 anomaly:** the printed word is "**motion**" (retained), read as "notion". - **Trap:** turning forms of life into cultural relativism; the background is largely *natural*.
- **Practice link:** MCQs 13-15; PYQ 2022 Q1(c).

Progress: 6 / 10 | Philosophy Layered Session | Subtopic: Rule-Following and the Paradox (PI 201) - Interpretation Regress, Practice and Going On

LAYER 1 - SIMPLE START

Visual gateway - the rule-following flow

RULE: "add 2" 2, 4, 6, 8, ... 996, 998, 1000, ...
|
pupil writes 1000, 1004, 1008 - "I AM adding 2!"
|
can you PROVE he is wrong just from the rule + examples?
every finite list fits MANY rules -> PARADOX (PI 201):
"no course of action could be determined by a rule,
because every course of action can be made to accord with it"
|
WRONG fix: add another rule to interpret the rule -> REGRESS
RIGHT view: rule-following is a PRACTICE - a trained way of
GOING ON, "exhibited in obeying the rule"

Caption: the meaning of a rule is not a further hidden rule; it shows itself in what we do.

Plain-language start: "Add 2" seems crystal clear - until a pupil, at 1000, writes 1004, 1008 and insists he is obeying "add 2" (just "add 2 up to 1000, then 4"). Nothing in the finite examples rules this out; every rule can be "interpreted" to fit any continuation. That is the paradox of PI 201. The tempting fix - supply *another* rule to say how to read the first - only launches an infinite regress. Wittgenstein's way out: following a rule is not *interpreting* at all; it is a *practice* - a shared, trained, mostly unreflective way of "going on" that shows itself in the doing.

Term	Plain meaning
The paradox (PI 201)	any action can be made to accord with a rule under some interpretation
Interpretation regress	a rule to fix the rule needs a rule... forever
Practice / going on	rule-following is a trained ability, exhibited in obeying
Normative correctness	there is still a right/wrong, grounded in shared practice

MEMORY: **Mnemonic - "PIP":** Paradox (any action fits) -> Interpretation regress (no escape by more rules) -> Practice (going on, trained).

LAYER 2 - CORE UPSC

4. RULE-FOLLOWING AND THE PARADOX (§201) FACT:

4.1 The Problem FACT:

What is it to *follow a rule*? Every rule can be interpreted in multiple ways. The rule "add 2" seems clear — but someone might interpret it as meaning "add 2 up to 1000, then add 4." No finite set of examples can fix a unique interpretation. So:

FACT: *"This was our paradox: no course of action could be determined by a rule, because every course of action can be made out to accord with the rule."* (Investigations §201)

If *any* action can be made to "accord" with the rule under some interpretation, then the rule determines nothing — and "according with a rule" becomes meaningless.

4.2 Resolution FACT:

Wittgenstein's response: the paradox shows that **following a rule cannot consist in interpreting it** (adding a further rule to govern the first rule -> regress). Rule-following is a **practice** — a shared, trained, unreflective way of going on. It is grounded in our common form of life, not in a mental act of interpretation.

FACT: *"There is a way of grasping a rule which is not an interpretation, but which is exhibited in what we call 'obeying the rule' and 'going against it' in actual cases."* (Investigations §201)

4.3 Relevance to Private Language ANALYSIS:

If rule-following requires a shared practice (with public criteria for correct/incorrect application), then a *purely private* rule — one that no one else *could in principle* check — is incoherent. This is the direct bridge to the private-language argument (§5 below). ANALYSIS:

LAYER 3 - ADVANCED

The argument, and why it matters downstream

- **The problem (PI 201).** "This was our paradox: no course of action could be determined by a rule, because every course of action can be made out to accord with the rule." If *any* action can be squared with the rule under some interpretation, then "according with the rule" determines nothing.
- **The resolution.** The paradox shows that grasping a rule *cannot consist in interpreting it* - "there is a way of grasping a rule which is not an interpretation, but which is exhibited in what we call 'obeying the rule' and 'going against it' in actual cases." Rule-following is a **custom, a practice**, grounded in training and, ultimately, in a shared form of life (subtopic 5). - **Normativity survives.** This is not "anything goes": within the practice there is a genuine right and wrong. What is denied is that correctness is fixed by a *private mental interpretation*; it is fixed by public, trained practice.
- **The bridge to private language.** If following a rule requires a shared practice with public criteria for correct application, then a *purely private* rule - one that no one else could in principle check - is incoherent. This is the direct hinge into subtopic 7.

ANALYSIS: name, but keep separate, the famous secondary reading - **Kripke's Wittgenstein ("Kripkenstein")**, which recasts 201 as a *sceptical paradox* about meaning and offers a *community/"sceptical solution"* (correctness = accord with the community). It is a powerful, examinable interpretation, but it is a *reading of* Wittgenstein, not his own words; Baker and Hacker contest it. Present the text first, then flag Kripke's community objection and reply as a labelled interpretive dispute - do not present it as the canonical doctrine.

Caution: the resolution is not "there are no rules" and not "rules are whatever the individual feels"; it is "rules are sustained by shared practice." Misreading 201 as endorsing the paradox (rather than dissolving it) is the classic error.

LAYER 4 - EXAM APPLICATION

Verified routes and answer architecture

- Rule-following is not a *named* PYQ owner in 2018-2025, but it is the **load-bearing premise** of the private-language questions (**2019 Q3(b)**, **2024 Q1(d)**, **2020 Q4(c)**). Any strong private-language answer states 201 first: a rule needs a public criterion of correct application. - **Deploy it as a two-sentence engine:** "Following a rule cannot be a private interpretation (regress); it is a practice with public criteria. Therefore a criterion available only to me is not a criterion at all - which is exactly why a private language fails." - **Directive care:** if a question mentions "rules", "meaning" or "understanding", 201 is the bridge; do not spend a whole answer on the arithmetic example - state the paradox, the regress, the practice-resolution, and move to the pay-off.

Use in private-language answers: paradox -> regress -> practice/going on -> "so a purely private rule is no rule" -> private language impossible.

LAYER 5 - RAPID REVISION

Rapid recall

- **PI 201 paradox:** "no course of action could be determined by a rule, because every course of action can be made out to accord with the rule." - **Regress point:** you cannot fix a rule by adding an interpretation - that needs its own rule, forever. - **Resolution:** grasping a rule is "**not an interpretation**" but is **exhibited in obeying**; rule-following is a **practice/custom** grounded in training and form of life. - **Normativity kept:** right/wrong survives, fixed by shared practice, not private seeming. - **Bridge:** public criterion of correctness -> **no private rule -> no private language**.
- **Interpretive flag: Kripkenstein** = sceptical paradox + community solution; a reading, contested by Baker/Hacker - keep labelled. - **Practice link:** MCQs 16-19; feeds PYQs 2019 Q3(b), 2024 Q1(d), 2020 Q4(c).

Progress: 7 / 10 | Philosophy Layered Session | Subtopic: The Private-Language Argument - Logical Privacy, the Diary 'S', the Beetle and Public Criteria

LAYER 1 - SIMPLE START

Visual gateway - the private diary argument

```
WHAT A PRIVATE LANGUAGE IS (get the definition right!)
NOT: a secret code (that is translatable -> public)
NOT: talking to yourself (English, others could hear)
YES: words for sensations only I can know, that NO ONE
      else could in principle understand = LOGICALLY private
-----
THE DIARY (PI 258): I write "S" each day I feel a sensation
Day 1: "S"    Day 2: "S"? ... is today's really S?
no independent check of "same" -> "right" has no grip
"whatever is going to seem right to me is right. And
that only means that here we can't talk about 'right'."
-----
THE BEETLE (PI 293): everyone has a box, calls its content
"beetle", no one can look in another's box. The word "beetle"
has a USE -> the thing in the box "drops out as irrelevant".
```

Caption: a sign with no possible public check of correct use is not functioning as a word at all.

Plain-language start: First, fix the target - this is the single biggest exam trap. A "private language" does *not* mean a secret code (codes can be cracked and shared) or muttering to yourself (that is ordinary language, just quiet). It means a language whose words refer to *inner sensations that only the speaker could possibly know*, so that *no one else could even in principle* understand it - **logically** private. Wittgenstein argues such a language is impossible. In the diary example (PI 258) you try to name a recurring private sensation "S"; but with nothing outside your impression to check against, "this is the same S again" has no independent standard - "whatever seems right will be right, and that only means we cannot talk of 'right' here." The beetle-in-a-box (PI 293) makes the point unforgettable: if the word "beetle" gets its use publicly, then *whatever is privately in the box* "drops out as irrelevant."

Term	Plain meaning
Logically private	in principle unknowable to anyone else, not merely secret
Diary "S" (PI 258)	naming a private sensation fails for lack of a correctness check
Correctness vs seeming	"seems right" is not "is right"; a rule needs an independent standard
Beetle-in-a-box (PI 293)	the private object drops out of the language-game as irrelevant
Public criteria	words for sensations get their sense from public circumstances

MEMORY: **Mnemonic - "DBC"**: Diary (no check) -> Beetle (object irrelevant) -> Criteria must be public.

LAYER 2 - CORE UPSC

5. THE CRITIQUE OF PRIVATE LANGUAGE FACT: (PYQ 2024, 2019)

5.1 What is a "Private Language"? FACT:

A **private language** in Wittgenstein's sense is one whose words refer to **the speaker's immediate private sensations** — sensations that are *logically* private (not merely contingently secret). The words would get their meaning from the private inner experience and could *in principle* not be taught to or understood by another. FACT:

ANALYSIS: **UPSC Trap — crucial clarification:** The private-language argument does NOT target: - A secret code (which could in principle be deciphered by another) — this is merely an encrypted public language. - Talking to oneself. - Having private thoughts. It targets the *logical possibility* of a language whose meaning is constituted by private ostensive definition of inner sensations — the Cartesian/empiricist dream of grounding all meaning in *my* private experience.

5.2 The Diary Argument ("S") FACT:

Suppose I decide to keep a diary of a certain recurring sensation. I write "S" each time the sensation occurs. To use "S" correctly, I must *re-identify* the same sensation each time. But:

1. There is **no independent criterion** of correctness — no public check, no physical correlation, nothing *outside* the private experience to settle whether today's sensation is the *same* as yesterday's.
2. **"Whatever seems right to me IS right"** — but that only means **we cannot talk about 'right' here**. The distinction between *correctly applying* the sign and *merely thinking* one applies it correctly **collapses**. FACT: 3. Without a genuine rule of use (with a real correct/incorrect distinction), "S" has **no meaning**. The private diarist is under the *illusion* of using a sign meaningfully.

FACT: "If whatever seems right to me is right, that only means that here we can't talk about 'right'." (Investigations §258, in substance)

5.3 The Beetle-in-a-Box FACT:

FACT: Suppose everyone has a box that only they can look into; each calls its content "beetle." No one can see into anyone else's box. What role does the "object in the box" play in the *language-game* of using "beetle"?

Answer: None. The word "beetle" gets its meaning from the public language-game — the circumstances of utterance, the reactions of others, the criteria of application. The private object "drops out of consideration as irrelevant" — it might be different for each person, or empty, or constantly changing. Meaning cannot be grounded in a private object. FACT:

5.4 The Criterion of Correctness Objection (Core Logic) ANALYSIS:

The *logical core* of the private-language argument:

1. A meaningful sign requires a **RULE OF USE** (a standard of correct/incorrect application).
2. A rule of use requires a **CRITERION OF CORRECTNESS** independent of mere seeming.
3. A purely private "rule" has **NO** such independent criterion (the subject is sole judge; whatever seems right IS right -> no distinction between right and seems-right).
4. Therefore, a purely private "rule" is **NOT** a rule.
5. Therefore, private language (grounded in private ostensive definition) is **IMPOSSIBLE**.

5.5 What the Argument Demolishes FACT:

Target	How it falls
Cartesian dualism's private mind	If language cannot be private, then the meaning of sensation-words ("pain," "blue") must be grounded in <i>public</i> criteria (behaviour, context), not in private inner experience. The "inner theatre" cannot be the foundation of meaning.
Classical empiricism's private sense-data	If I cannot even <i>name</i> my private sense-data meaningfully, sense-data cannot serve as the epistemological foundation.
The referential theory of meaning (for sensations)	"Pain" does not get its meaning by referring to a private object called "pain." It gets its meaning from its place in public language-games involving pain-behaviour, expression, treatment, etc.
Solipsism (PYQ 2019 Q3(b))	If language is necessarily public, the solipsist's claim — "only my experience is real" — cannot even be <i>stated</i> meaningfully. The "I" of solipsism presupposes the public language it would deny. -> The private-language argument <i>is</i> the critique of solipsism. FACT:

5.6 Relation to Solipsism (PYQ 2019 Q3(b)) FACT:

Wittgenstein's critique of solipsism is not a separate argument but a *consequence* of the private-language argument:

1. The solipsist claims: "Only my experiences are real; the external world and other minds may not exist."
2. But to make this claim, the solipsist must use language — and language is necessarily public (grounded in shared practice, learnable criteria, forms of life).
3. The very language in which solipsism is expressed *presupposes* a public world and other speakers. 4. Therefore, solipsism is self-undermining — it tries to *say* what, if true, would make *saying* impossible.

ANALYSIS: The *Tractatus* had already gestured at this: "What the solipsist *means* is quite correct, only it cannot be *said*" (5.62). The later Wittgenstein makes the impossibility of private language the explicit ground for why it cannot be said — or even thought coherently.

LAYER 3 - ADVANCED

The argument in steps, plus the solipsism connection

- **Step 1 - the definition (do not skip).** Private language = signs for *logically private* sensations, unintelligible in principle to others. Rule out the impostors: codes (translatable), soliloquy (public language spoken quietly), contingently unshared jargon.
- **Step 2 - the need for a criterion of correctness.** From rule-following (subtopic 6): using a word correctly requires a standard independent of one's mere impression of correctness. Meaning needs the possibility of a *mistake*.
- **Step 3 - the diary (PI 258).** I define "S" by concentrating on a sensation and writing "S" when it recurs. But I have no independent check that today's "S" is the same as yesterday's; the only court of appeal is my present impression. "One would like to say: whatever is going to seem right to me is right. And that only means that here we can't talk about 'right'." Without a possible wrong, there is no right - so "S" names nothing; the sign is idling. -
- **Step 4 - the beetle (PI 293).** Suppose everyone has a "beetle" in a box only they can see. The public word "beetle" does its work regardless of the box's content, which might even be empty or constantly changing. "The thing in the box has no place in the language-game at all; not even as a *something*: for the box might even be empty." Meaning is carried by public use, not by a private inner object.
- **Step 5 - solipsism.** The private-language argument is Wittgenstein's dissolution of the solipsist/Cartesian starting point: the idea that each of us first knows only our own private inner world, and language names it inwardly. If that inner naming cannot even establish a rule for one word, the solipsist's "private world known only to me" cannot be a language at all - it is self-undermining. This is precisely the route the 2019 question demands ("critique of solipsism culminates in the critique of private language").

ANALYSIS: the argument does **not** deny that we have sensations, pains or an inner life (that misreading is the behaviourism charge, subtopic 8). It denies that a sensation can be a *private semantic foundation* - a meaning fixed by inner ostension alone. The move is from "meaning is private inner reference" to "meaning is public criterion-governed use." Keep the target precise and the beetle does the rest.

Caution: never paraphrase the beetle as "we can't know others' minds" - that is the very Cartesian scepticism Wittgenstein is dissolving, not endorsing. The beetle shows the private object is *irrelevant to meaning*, not "hidden behind a veil".

LAYER 4 - EXAM APPLICATION

Verified routes and answer architecture

This subtopic owns **three** of the seven PYQs - the exam core of Later Wittgenstein.

- **2019 Q3(b), 15 marks:** "Show how Wittgenstein's critique of solipsism culminates in the critique of private language." Spine: solipsist premise (I know only my private inner world) -> to *speak* of it needs a language -> a private language needs a correctness criterion -> diary 258 shows none is available -> beetle 293 shows the private object is irrelevant -> so the solipsist's private world cannot even be *said*; the critique of solipsism *is* the critique of private language.
- **2020 Q4(c), 15 marks:** quotes the PI 243-style question ("could we imagine a language... for his private use?") and asks for Wittgenstein's answer, *critically*. Spine: state the question -> "No" -> definition -> diary -> beetle -> public criteria (subtopic 8) -> assess (strength: dissolves Cartesian foundation; objection: behaviourism charge, then reply).
- **2024 Q1(d), 10 marks:** "Why does later Wittgenstein think that there cannot be a language that only one person can speak - a language that is essentially private?" Spine (tighter): definition -> no correctness criterion (diary) -> beetle -> public criteria; one-line close. - **Directive care:** 2019/2020 are 15-markers wanting a *critical* culmination and assessment; 2024 is a 10-marker wanting the core reason cleanly.

Master spine (scale by marks): definition (logical privacy) -> criterion of correctness (from 201) -> diary 258 -> beetle 293 -> public criteria -> [15/20 only: behaviourism objection + reply] -> verdict.

LAYER 5 - RAPID REVISION

Rapid recall

- **Private language (exact target):** words for **logically private** sensations, unintelligible to others *in principle* - NOT a code, NOT talking to yourself.
- **Diary 258:** name a private sensation "S"; no independent check of "same" -> "whatever seems right is right" -> "we can't talk about 'right'." No possible mistake -> no meaning. - **Beetle 293:** private object "drops out as irrelevant"; "the box might even be empty." Meaning = public use. - **Public criteria:** sensation-words get sense from public circumstances (feeds subtopic 8). - **Solipsism (2019):** the critique of solipsism *culminates in* the critique of private language - the private world cannot even be said.
- **Trap:** it does NOT deny inner life or claim "we can't know other minds." - **Practice link:** MCQs 20-23; PYQs 2019 Q3(b), 2020 Q4(c), 2024 Q1(d).

Progress: 8 / 10 | Philosophy Layered Session | Subtopic: Criteria vs Symptoms, PI 580 Outward Criteria and the Behaviourism Charge Answered

LAYER 1 - SIMPLE START

Visual gateway - criteria vs symptoms

HOW DOES "PAIN" CONNECT TO BEHAVIOUR? two very different links

CRITERION	SYMPTOM
GRAMMATICAL link fixes what the word MEANS wincing, crying, guarding = criteria for "pain"	INDUCTIVE / empirical link correlated by experience e.g. a pallor we have learned often accompanies pain
DEFEASIBLE (can be overridden: acting)	can fail without touching meaning

PI 580: "An 'inner process' stands in need of outward criteria."
angina analogy: some signs DEFINE (criteria), some merely
ACCOMPANY (symptoms) - and the two can shift with knowledge.

Caption: behaviour is not evidence for a hidden thing; certain behaviour in context is part of what the sensation-word *means* - though defeasibly.

Plain-language start: If sensation-words are not fixed by a private object, how do they connect to the world? Through **criteria** - publicly available circumstances and behaviour that are part of the *grammar* (the meaning) of the word, not mere clues to a hidden thing. A **symptom**, by contrast, is something *experience* has taught us tends to accompany the state - an inductive correlation. Criteria are *grammatical* (they help fix meaning); symptoms are *empirical* (they are correlated). Both matter, and the same phenomenon can be a criterion in one context and a symptom in another. Crucially, criteria are **defeasible**: someone can wince and *not* be in pain (acting), and that possibility does not destroy the meaning-link - it is built into it. PI 580 compresses the whole idea: "An 'inner process' stands in need of outward criteria."

Term	Plain meaning
Criterion	a publicly available circumstance that partly <i>fixes the meaning</i> of a term (grammatical)
Symptom	something experience correlates with a state (inductive/empirical)
Defeasible	a criterion can be overridden in a case without ceasing to be a criterion
PI 580	"an inner process stands in need of outward criteria"
First-person asymmetry	I avow my pain ("It hurts"), I do not <i>observe</i> it by its criteria

MEMORY: Mnemonic - "CGDS": Criteria are Grammatical and Defeasible; Symptoms are inductive.

LAYER 2 - CORE UPSC

5.7 CRITERIA vs SYMPTOMS FACT: — the distinction that saves the argument from behaviourism

Why you need it. Without this distinction the private-language argument looks like the claim that "pain" *means* pain-behaviour — i.e. behaviourism. With it, Wittgenstein can hold that the connection between behaviour and pain is **grammatical** (constitutive of the concept) without being **reductive** (an identity).

Exact printed subterms: *criterion* (*Kriterium*) · *symptom* (*Symptom*) · "defining criterion" · "fluctuation in grammar between criteria and symptoms" (PI §354) · *outward criteria* (§580) · *Lebensform* (form of life).

	CRITERION	SYMPTOM
Relation to the concept	Internal / grammatical — part of what it <i>is</i> for the concept to apply; fixed by convention and taught in learning the word	External / inductive — a correlation experience has taught us, discovered by observation

	CRITERION	SYMPTOM
How established	By the grammar of the language-game; not by evidence	By empirical investigation
If it fails	We would not know what the word means any more — the concept would lose its footing	We would merely revise a generalisation; the concept is untouched
Wittgenstein's own example (<i>Blue Book</i>)	For angina : the presence of a particular bacillus in the blood, which we have <i>defined</i> as the criterion	For angina : the inflamed throat , which experience has taught us usually goes with it
For pain	Pain-behaviour in appropriate circumstances is a criterion for "he is in pain"	A raised pulse, sweating, a groan produced by an actor — evidence at best

The three points that must be made ANALYSIS::

1. **Criteria are defeasible.** That pain-behaviour is a criterion does not mean it is conclusive: pretence, acting and suppression are all possible. Criteria give *non-inductive but defeasible* grounds. This is what blocks the inference to behaviourism.
2. **Criteria are not evidence for something hidden.** They are not clues from which we infer an inner event; they are the circumstances in which the concept has its home.
3. **The grammar fluctuates.** FACT: "In the practice of the use of language one party calls out the words, the other acts on them... The fluctuation in grammar between criteria and symptoms makes it look as if there were nothing at all but symptoms" (PI §354, in substance). What is a criterion in one language-game may be a symptom in another; the distinction is not a fixed taxonomy but a grammatical role.

5.8 "AN INNER PROCESS STANDS IN NEED OF OUTWARD CRITERIA" — PI §580 FACT:

FACT: "An 'inner process' stands in need of outward criteria." (*Philosophical Investigations* §580)

This one sentence is the hinge of the entire treatment of mind, and it is the single most quotable line in this file. Note precisely what it says and does not say:

It does say	It does not say
That the concept of an inner process has application only where there are outward criteria for its application	That there are no inner processes
That "remembering," "intending," "expecting," "understanding" are not names of private episodes we then report	That mental life is nothing but behaviour
That the <i>grammar</i> of psychological words is fixed in public practice	That my pain is <i>someone else's</i> business, or that I infer my own pain from my behaviour ANALYSIS: first-person asymmetry: I do not use criteria in my own case at all — I simply avow

The argument, numbered:

1. To possess a concept is to master a technique of applying a word correctly and incorrectly (§§143–202).
2. Mastery requires that there be circumstances in which application is right and circumstances in which it is wrong.
3. For a putatively "inner" concept, those circumstances cannot themselves be further inner items — that would restart the same problem one level down (a private criterion for a private criterion).
4. therefore the circumstances must be outward — behaviour, situation, what precedes and follows, the surroundings that Wittgenstein calls the "**surroundings**" or *Umgebung* of the utterance.
5. therefore an inner process stands in need of outward criteria.

5.9 THE BEHAVIOURISM CHARGE — AND THE REPLY FACT: (PI §§304, 307–308)

Wittgenstein raises the objection **against himself**, in the interlocutor's voice, which is why quoting it is so effective:

FACT: "Aren't you at bottom really saying that everything except human behaviour is a fiction?" — "If I do speak of a fiction, then it is of a **grammatical fiction**." (§307, in substance)

The reply, in four moves ANALYSIS::

1. **The denial is of a picture, not of a phenomenon.** What is rejected is the model of sensation as an **inner object** privately named — not the reality of pain, joy or memory. §304: "It is **not a something, but not a nothing either!** The conclusion was only that a nothing would serve just as well as a something about which nothing could be said." 2. **The first false step.** §308 diagnoses how the problem arises: we begin by talking innocently of mental "processes and states" while leaving their nature undecided — "and now the analogy which was to make us understand our thoughts falls to pieces... **the decisive movement in the conjuring trick has been made, and it was the very one that we thought quite innocent.**" 3. **Criteria ≠ definition.** Because criteria are defeasible (§5.7), "he is in pain" is not *equivalent to* any statement about behaviour. The behaviourist asserts an equivalence; Wittgenstein asserts a grammatical dependence. **This is the whole difference, and stating it is what an examiner is looking for.**
4. **The first/third person asymmetry.** The behaviourist must treat "I am in pain" and "he is in pain" symmetrically. Wittgenstein does not: the first-person utterance is not a report based on criteria but an **avowal** (*Äußerung*) which replaces the natural expression of pain — a cry — rather than describing an inner object (§244).

ANALYSIS: **Verdict to deploy:** "Wittgenstein is not a behaviourist but an **anti-Cartesian without being a reductionist**. He removes the inner object while keeping the inner life, by relocating the meaning of psychological words from private ostension to public criteria. Whether this position is stable — whether one can deny the inner object and still respect the phenomenology of the first person — is the standing dispute between Hacker's and Kripke's readings."

LAYER 3 - ADVANCED

The distinction, PI 580, and the behaviourism reply

- **Grammatical vs inductive.** A criterion is fixed by convention/grammar as (part of) what justifies applying the word; a symptom is fixed by experience as a correlate. Wittgenstein's own contrast: with angina, we may *define* the condition by one thing (say the bacillus - a criterion) while other phenomena are *symptoms* we have found to accompany it; what is criterion and what is symptom can shift as knowledge changes. The point is that the criterial link to "pain" is *conceptual*, not merely evidential.
- **Defeasibility is the hinge.** Because criteria can be defeated (pretence, acting, suppression) without being falsified as criteria, Wittgenstein is *not* reducing pain to behaviour. A behaviourist reduction ("pain just *is* pain-behaviour") cannot allow pretence; Wittgenstein's criterial account positively *requires* that pain and pain-behaviour can come apart. That is the reply to the behaviourism charge in one stroke.
- **PI 580: "An 'inner process' stands in need of outward criteria."** This does not deny inner processes; it states their *grammar* - talk of the inner is anchored to public criteria, otherwise (per the private-language argument) it could not be meaningful talk at all.
- **First-person asymmetry / avowal.** I do not find out that I am in pain by observing my own wincing; "It hurts" is an *avowal* (*Äusserung*), a learned extension of natural pain-expression, not a report based on criteria. Criteria govern the *third-person* application ("he is in pain"); the first-person case is asymmetric. Preserving this asymmetry is what stops the account from collapsing into behaviourism from the other side.

ANALYSIS: the criterion/symptom distinction is the technical device that lets Wittgenstein occupy the *middle ground* - neither Cartesian inner-object semantics (refuted in subtopic 7) nor behaviourist reduction (refuted here). Examiners reward candidates who name this middle position explicitly: meaning is fixed by *defeasible public criteria*, while the inner life is neither denied nor made the semantic foundation.

Caution: do not say "criteria are just very reliable symptoms" - that collapses grammar into induction and hands the behaviourist the win. The difference is in *kind* (meaning-constituting vs experience-correlated), not in degree.

LAYER 4 - EXAM APPLICATION

Verified routes and answer architecture

- This subtopic is the **decisive second half** of every private-language answer - especially the 15/20-mark ones (2020 Q4(c), 2019 Q3(b)), where "critically discuss" demands you raise the **behaviourism charge and answer it**. Deploy: criteria are grammatical and *defeasible* -> pain and pain-behaviour can come apart -> therefore not behaviourism; PI 580 anchors the inner to outward criteria without denying it; first-person avowal preserves asymmetry.
- **PI 580** is a one-line quotable that instantly signals command of the criterial account. - **Cite the canonical sections where the text carries them:** PI 580 (outward criteria); the anti-behaviourism clarifications at PI 304 ("It is not a something, but not a nothing either!") and 307-308 (the "grammatical fiction", rejecting the *picture* of an inner object, not the inner life).
- **Directive care:** reserve this subtopic for the *assessment* segment of 15/20-mark answers; at 10 marks (2024) a single sentence ("sensation-words are anchored to public, defeasible criteria, not to a private object") suffices.

Assessment segment (15/20): state behaviourism objection -> criteria are defeasible/grammatical -> pain != pain-behaviour -> PI 580 + first-person avowal -> verdict: the account is a third way, not behaviourism.

LAYER 5 - RAPID REVISION

Rapid recall

- **Criterion = grammatical** (helps fix meaning, *defeasible*); **symptom = inductive** (experience-correlated). Not a difference of degree. - **PI 580:** "An 'inner process' stands in need of **outward criteria**." States grammar; does not deny the inner. - **Defeasibility** is the anti-behaviourism hinge: wincing without pain (acting) is possible -> pain != pain-behaviour -> **not behaviourism**. - **Behaviourism reply (PI 304, 307-308):** Wittgenstein rejects the inner *object* as semantic foundation ("grammatical fiction"), **not** the inner life - "not a something, but not a nothing either." - **First-person avowal:** "It hurts" is an *expression*, not a criterion-based report; criteria govern the third-person case (asymmetry).
- **Trap:** "criteria are reliable symptoms" (collapses grammar into induction). - **Practice link:** MCQs 24-27; feeds PYQs 2020 Q4(c), 2019 Q3(b).

Progress: 9 / 10 | Philosophy Layered Session | Subtopic: Philosophy as Therapy - Language on Holiday, the Fly-Bottle, Perspicuous Representation and 'Leaves Everything as It Is'

LAYER 1 - SIMPLE START

Visual gateway - the therapy map (out of the fly-bottle)

HOW PHILOSOPHICAL PROBLEMS ARISE, AND DISSOLVE

- (1) language "goes on HOLIDAY" - a word idles, torn from its home language-game ("What is TIME?" with no ordinary use)
- (2) we are BEWITCHED: "philosophy is a battle against the bewitchment of our intelligence by means of language"
- (3) THERAPY = DESCRIBE the ordinary use; assemble reminders; build a PERSPICUOUS (surveyable) representation (PI 122)
- (4) the problem DISSOLVES (it is not solved by a theory):
"to show the fly the way out of the fly-bottle" (PI 309)

"Philosophy may in no way interfere with the actual use of language; it can in the end only describe it. ... it leaves everything as it is." (PI 124)

Caption: the aim is not a doctrine but relief - a clear view that makes the false problem disappear.

Plain-language start: Why do philosophical puzzles feel so deep and so stuck? Because a word has "gone on holiday" - lifted out of the ordinary activity where it works and made to spin ("What is *time*? What is *meaning*? Where is the *self*?"). We get "bewitched" by our own language. Wittgenstein's therapy is not to build a rival theory but to *bring*

the words home: describe their ordinary use, assemble reminders, and arrange them into a **perspicuous (surveyable) representation** so we "command a clear view" and the knot unties itself. The image is unforgettable - philosophy's aim is "to show the fly the way out of the fly-bottle." And because it only describes, "philosophy leaves everything as it is."

Term	Plain meaning
Language on holiday	a word idling away from its home language-game breeds pseudo-problems
Bewitchment	philosophical confusion is language misleading the intellect
Perspicuous representation (PI 122)	arranging what we know so we "see connexions" - the positive method
Fly-bottle (PI 309)	therapy = showing the fly the way out; dissolving, not solving
Leaves everything as it is (PI 124)	philosophy describes; it advances no theses and changes nothing

MEMORY: Mnemonic - "HBPF": Holiday -> Bewitchment -> Perspicuous view -> Fly-bottle exit.

LAYER 2 - CORE UPSC

3.5 Philosophical Consequence — Therapy FACT:

FACT: "Philosophy is a battle against the bewitchment of our intelligence by means of language." (Investigations §109)

Philosophical problems arise when **language goes on holiday** — when a term is torn from its home language-game and deployed in a context where it has no established use. "Where does the flame go when it goes out?" "What is time in itself?" These are not profound questions awaiting solution; they are symptoms of linguistic confusion.

FACT: "Philosophy leaves everything as it is." (Investigations §124)

Philosophy does not *discover* new facts or build theories. It *describes* the workings of language and thereby *dissolves* the puzzlement that arises from misusing it. This is the **therapeutic** conception. FACT:

5A. PHILOSOPHY AS THERAPY — LANGUAGE ON HOLIDAY AND THE FLY-BOTTLE FACT:

Thesis. Philosophical problems are not questions awaiting discoveries; they are **confusions** produced when language is taken out of the practice that gives it sense. The method is therefore **diagnostic and dissolving**, not constructive.

The five load-bearing images and remarks FACT::

Remark	PI §	What it does
"Philosophical problems arise when language goes on holiday" (<i>wenn die Sprache feiert</i> — literally when language <i>idles</i> , is not at work)	§38	Locates the origin of the problem: a word removed from its language-game keeps its surface grammar but loses its use
"A picture held us captive. And we could not get outside it, for it lay in our language and language seemed to repeat it to us inexorably."	§115	Names the mechanism: a <i>Bild</i> — the inner object, the essence, the hidden mechanism of meaning
"A philosophical problem has the form: 'I don't know my way about.'" (<i>Ich kenne mich nicht aus</i>)	§123	Reclassifies the difficulty: it is disorientation , not ignorance of a fact
"The philosopher's treatment of a question is like the treatment of an illness."	§255	The therapeutic analogy stated outright

Remark	PI §	What it does
FACT: "What is your aim in philosophy? — To show the fly the way out of the fly-bottle." (<i>der Fliege den Ausweg aus dem Fliegenglas zeigen</i>)	§309	The governing image of the whole method

Reading the fly-bottle image correctly ANALYSIS: (this is where marks are won or lost):

1. The fly-bottle is a trap that is **open at the top** — the fly is not physically imprisoned. Nothing holds it but its own manner of trying to escape: it batters at the glass, which is transparent, because it can see the outside.
2. therefore the philosopher's predicament is **self-generated**. The exit was always available.
3. therefore the remedy is not a new theory but a change in how one goes about it — showing the *way out*, not supplying an *answer*.
4. therefore there is no philosophical thesis to replace the confused one: "**Philosophy... leaves everything as it is**" (§124); "**If one tried to advance theses in philosophy, it would never be possible to debate them, because everyone would agree to them**" (§128). 5. therefore success is measured by **cessation**, not by discovery: "**The real discovery is the one that makes me capable of stopping doing philosophy when I want to**" (§133).

Presuppositions ANALYSIS:: (P1) every genuine question has a home in some practice; (P2) philosophical theses that survive scrutiny are grammatical remarks in disguise; (P3) description suffices — "**we may not advance any kind of theory. There must not be anything hypothetical in our considerations. We must do away with all explanation, and description alone must take its place**" (§109).

Strongest objections -> replies CAUTION::

Objection	Reply	Residual
Quietism/conservatism: "leaves everything as it is" removes philosophy's critical function, including social critique.	The claim concerns <i>conceptual</i> description, not social practice; therapy removes confusion and does not forbid reform.	ANALYSIS: But the range of what philosophy may legitimately do is deliberately and severely narrowed; the charge is not fully answered.
Self-application: the therapeutic method is itself a philosophical thesis about philosophy, so it refutes itself.	Wittgenstein accepts a version of this: his remarks are themselves ladder-like, and §133 speaks of " methods , like different therapies," in the plural — there is no single doctrine.	CAUTION: Structurally the same problem as the <i>Tractatus</i> ladder — continuity between early and late Wittgenstein on this precise point is a first-class exam observation.
Some philosophical problems are real (personal identity, free will, the status of mathematics) and survive any amount of grammatical clarification.	Wittgenstein would treat their persistence as evidence that the picture holding us captive has not yet been fully exhibited.	ANALYSIS: Unfalsifiable as stated; this is the most serious methodological complaint.

Authored bridge - "perspicuous representation" (PI 122). The canonical file describes the therapeutic method fully but does not use the textbook English label for its central positive tool, so it is supplied here for completeness. Wittgenstein calls the goal *eine übersichtliche Darstellung* - rendered as a "**perspicuous representation**" (also translated "**surveyable representation**"): an arrangement of the grammatical facts we already know so that we *command a clear view* of our use of words. "A perspicuous representation produces just that kind of understanding which consists in 'seeing connexions'." (PI 122) It is the antidote to the confusion the therapy treats: not new information, but a re-ordering of the familiar until the knot is visible and dissolves.

LAYER 3 - ADVANCED

The method, stated as doctrine

- **Diagnosis: language idling.** "Philosophical problems arise when language goes on holiday." The confusion is not empirical ignorance but conceptual - a word cut from its use. Hence problems are to be *dissolved*, not answered.
- **The disease: bewitchment.** "Philosophy is a battle against the bewitchment of our intelligence by means of language." (PI 109) The philosopher's job is diagnostic. - **The positive tool: perspicuous representation (PI 122, authored above).** Therapy is not mere debunking; it assembles "reminders for a particular purpose" (PI 127) and arranges the grammar we already command into a surveyable whole so that we "see connexions". This is the constructive core people often miss when they caricature the later Wittgenstein as purely negative. - **The result: dissolution.** "What is your aim in philosophy? - To show the fly the way out of the fly-bottle." (PI 309) The problem does not get a theory; it stops seeming compulsory. - **The self-limit: quietism.** "Philosophy may in no way interfere with the actual use of language... It leaves everything as it is." (PI 124) "Philosophy simply puts everything before us, and neither explains nor deduces anything." (PI 126) There are no philosophical theses, or if there were, everyone would agree to them (PI 128). - **Plurality of therapies.** "There is not a philosophical method, though there are indeed methods, like different therapies." (PI 133) The treatment is case-by-case, matched to the particular knot.

ANALYSIS: hold two things together or you will misrepresent him. (i) The method is *deflationary* - no theses, no explanations, leaves everything as it is. (ii) It is not *empty* - perspicuous representation is a real, positive achievement ("seeing connexions"), and "the real discovery is the one that gives philosophy peace" (PI 133). The exam-strong reading: later Wittgenstein replaces *theory-construction* with *therapeutic description*, whose success-condition is intellectual peace, not a new set of truths.

Provenance caution: these are numbered *Investigations* remarks (Part I), posthumous 1953.

"Perspicuous/surveyable representation" translates *übersichtliche Darstellung* (PI 122); flag the translation variance as you would for §43.

LAYER 4 - EXAM APPLICATION

Verified routes and answer architecture

- Philosophy-as-therapy is not a *named* PYQ owner, but it is the **conclusion segment** that lifts a 15/20-mark answer from competent to distinctive. In **2023 Q4(c)** and **2025 Q3(a)** the "so what?" of the shift is precisely this: meaning-as-use turns philosophy from theory-building into therapeutic description. - **Deploy as a closing paragraph:** "The shift is ultimately methodological: if meaning is use, philosophical problems are knots in language on holiday, to be dissolved by a perspicuous representation - 'to show the fly the way out of the fly-bottle' - so that philosophy 'leaves everything as it is'." - **Directive care:** for "critically discuss", pair the method with its standing objection - that pure description is either impossible (all description is theory-laden) or self-refuting (the claim "there are no theses" is itself a thesis). Note the reply: Wittgenstein offers *reminders*, not a metaphysics, and measures success by peace, not by proof.

Closing segment (any 15/20): language on holiday -> bewitchment -> perspicuous representation -> fly-bottle -> leaves everything as it is -> one line on the self-reference objection and reply.

LAYER 5 - RAPID REVISION

Rapid recall

- **Diagnosis:** "philosophical problems arise when **language goes on holiday**"; "philosophy is a battle against the **bewitchment** of our intelligence by means of language" (PI 109). - **Positive tool: perspicuous / surveyable representation** (PI 122, *ubersichtliche Darstellung*) - arrange the familiar so we "see connexions".
- **Aim:** "to show the fly the way out of the **fly-bottle**" (PI 309) - problems are **dissolved**, not solved. - **Self-limit (quietism):** "philosophy **leaves everything as it is**" (PI 124); no theses (PI 128); "puts everything before us" (PI 126). - **Plurality:** "not a philosophical method, though there are... **different therapies**" (PI 133). - **Objection/reply:** "no theses" looks self-refuting -> reply: reminders, not metaphysics; success = intellectual peace. - **Practice link:** MCQs 28-30; closing segment for PYQs 2023 Q4(c), 2025 Q3(a).

Progress: 10 / 10 | Philosophy Layered Session | Subtopic: Aspect-Seeing and the Duck-Rabbit - Seeing-As, the Dawning of an Aspect and Aspect-Blindness

LAYER 1 - SIMPLE START

Visual gateway - the duck-rabbit

THE DUCK-RABBIT (Jastrow's figure, PI Part II xi / PPF)

```
 /  _-'-.      look LEFT -> a DUCK's bill
(  o      >      (the two marks point away)
 \  _-'-.      look RIGHT -> a RABBIT's ears
  ' ' ' '      (the same marks are ears)
```

SAME lines on the page. The DRAWING does not change.
What changes is the ASPECT under which you SEE it.

"Now I see it as a rabbit" = SEEING-AS (seeing an aspect)
the sudden switch = the DAWNING of an aspect ("Now a duck!")
someone who could never switch = ASPECT-BLIND
half experience / half thought: "'seeing as ...' is not part
of perception. And for that reason it is like seeing, and
again not like seeing."

Caption: perception is not the passive intake of raw data; how we see is shot through with concepts, technique and mastery.

Plain-language start: Look at Jastrow's duck-rabbit: the very same marks are now a duck, now a rabbit. Nothing on the paper changed - what changed is the *aspect* you see it under. Wittgenstein calls this **seeing-as** or **seeing an aspect**, and the sudden flip - "now it's a rabbit!" - the **dawning of an aspect**. Someone who could never experience the switch would be **aspect-blind**. The lesson reaches back into the whole philosophy: seeing is not just receiving raw data and then interpreting; the *concepts and techniques we have mastered are already in the seeing*. Aspect-seeing is "half visual experience, half thought" - and it is *not* the same as forming an interpretation or inference.

Term	Plain meaning
Seeing-as / seeing an aspect	seeing something as a duck, as a rabbit - concept in the perception
Dawning of an aspect	the sudden switch, "now I see it as..."
Aspect-blindness	inability to experience aspect-change (a limiting notion)
Not an interpretation	aspect-seeing is a mode of <i>experience</i> , not a theory-laden inference

MEMORY: **Mnemonic - "SAD-N":** Seeing-As, Dawning of aspect, Not interpretation (aspect-blind is the limit case).

LAYER 2 - CORE UPSC

5B. ASPECT-SEEING AND THE DUCK-RABBIT FACT: (Investigations, Part II §xi / "Philosophy of Psychology — A Fragment")

Why it belongs in this file. Aspect-seeing is where the later philosophy shows that even *perception* is not a bare given but is internally bound up with mastery of concepts and techniques. It completes the demolition of the sense-datum foundation that Russell and the positivists built on, and it explains the "experience of meaning."

The phenomenon. Jastrow's **duck-rabbit** figure can be seen as a duck or as a rabbit. Wittgenstein's crucial observation:

FACT: "I see that it has not changed; and yet I see it differently."

The puzzle, numbered:

1. Nothing in the drawing alters — the lines, the ink and the retinal image are identical before and after.
2. Yet something genuinely changes: I now see a **rabbit** where I saw a **duck**. Wittgenstein calls this the **dawning of an aspect** (*das Aufleuchten eines Aspekts*). 3. So the change is neither in the object (nothing physical altered) nor merely in my *interpretation* (I do not *infer* the rabbit — the change is immediate and visual).
4. therefore "Seeing-as" is a **third** category, neither pure perception nor pure judgement: it is "half visual experience, half thought."
5. therefore concepts are not applied *after* perception; the ability to see the aspect **presupposes mastery of a technique** — Wittgenstein notes that one must be familiar with the shape of a rabbit to see the rabbit-aspect at all.
6. therefore **Aspect-blindness**: we can conceive of someone who has full visual acuity, and can identify both figures on request, yet is incapable of the *dawning* of an aspect. Such a person's relation to meaning would also be impoverished — which is why aspect-seeing illuminates the **experience of meaning** (hearing a word "in a particular sense," feeling a word to "fit").

Consequences to deploy ANALYSIS::

Target	Damage done
Sense-data / the Given	If what I see depends on what I can do with concepts, no perceptual layer is conceptually innocent. The Russellian foundation of acquaintance is undermined from a new direction — see Moore-Russell-EarlyWittgenstein.md §4.7.
The picture theory	A picture does not depict <i>of itself</i> ; it depicts only within a practice of use. The <i>Tractatus</i> had assumed that the picturing relation was intrinsic to the picture. This is a self-criticism.
Meaning as inner process	The dawning of an aspect <i>feels</i> like an inner event, yet its criteria are what one does and says next. §580 applies here as elsewhere.
Philosophy's own method	Wittgenstein's therapy just is the attempt to make a new aspect dawn — to make us see the familiar language-game differently, without adding a single new fact. This is the deepest connection between §5B and §5A, and it is worth an explicit sentence in any answer on his method.

LAYER 3 - ADVANCED

Why the duck-rabbit belongs in a meaning-and-use philosophy

- **Perception is technique-laden.** To see the figure as a rabbit you must already have mastered the concept "rabbit" and the technique of applying it. So even perceiving is continuous with the trained, rule-governed capacities that underlie meaning-as-use. Aspect-seeing thus generalises the book's central theme: *mastery of a technique* reaches all the way into how the world looks.
- **"Not part of perception" and "not an interpretation".** Wittgenstein places seeing-as in a peculiar category: "'Seeing as...' is not part of perception. And for that reason it is like seeing, and again not like seeing." It is *not* an inference we draw from neutral data ("these lines therefore a rabbit"); the aspect is *lived*, immediate, experiential. This blocks the intellectualist model on which we always perceive bare sense-data and then interpret.
- **Aspect-blindness as a diagnostic.** By imagining someone who could not see the switch, Wittgenstein isolates what aspect-perception adds - and connects it to *meaning-blindness*: someone deaf to the way a word can be experienced with a particular meaning ("say 'bank' and mean the river-side"). This ties aspect-seeing back to the experience of meaning.
- **Provenance note.** The material sits in *Investigations* Part II, section xi - in later scholarship (Hacker/Schulte) printed as **Philosophy of Psychology - A Fragment (PPF)** rather than "Part II". The figure is **Jastrow's** duck-rabbit, which Wittgenstein borrows. Cite it as PI Part II xi / PPF, not as a numbered Part I remark.

ANALYSIS: the philosophical payload is anti-empiricist about perception. If we always saw neutral data and *then* interpreted, aspect-seeing would just be re-interpreting - but Wittgenstein denies this: the aspect *dawns*, it is seen, not concluded. Perception already involves the conceptual mastery that his account of meaning made central. That is why the duck-rabbit is not a party trick appended to the book but a capstone showing the reach of "mastery of a technique".

Caution: do not equate seeing-as with interpretation or hypothesis; and do not treat aspect-blindness as a clinical claim - it is a *conceptual* device to show what aspect-perception contributes.

LAYER 4 - EXAM APPLICATION

Verified routes and answer architecture

- Aspect-seeing is not a *named* PYQ owner in 2018-2025, but it is a high-value **enrichment** for any question on perception, meaning-experience, or the *scope* of the later philosophy, and a distinctive closing illustration for **2025 Q3(a)** (how far the "use" turn reaches - even into seeing). - **Deploy as a one-paragraph capstone:** the duck-rabbit shows that mastery of a technique (the engine of meaning-as-use) reaches into perception itself; seeing-as is experiential, not interpretive; aspect-blindness isolates what it adds. - **Provenance discipline earns marks:** cite **PI Part II xi / PPF**, credit **Jastrow's** figure, and keep it separate from numbered Part I remarks. - **Directive care:** only bring aspect-seeing into a private-language or forms-of-life answer if the question's scope invites it; otherwise it is an enrichment, not the spine.

Capstone segment: duck-rabbit -> seeing-as / dawning -> not an interpretation -> aspect-blindness -> "technique reaches into perception" -> (provenance) PPF / Jastrow.

LAYER 5 - RAPID REVISION

Rapid recall

- **Duck-rabbit** (Jastrow; PI Part II xi / **PPF**): same marks, different **aspect**. The drawing does not change; the *seeing* does.
- **Seeing-as / seeing an aspect;** the flip = **dawning of an aspect**; the limit case = **aspect-blindness**. - **"Not part of perception... like seeing, and again not like seeing"** - it is **not an interpretation/inference**; the aspect is *experienced*.
- **Payload:** perception is **technique-laden** - the mastery behind meaning-as-use reaches into how we see; anti-empiricist about "bare data + interpretation". - **Meaning-blindness** parallel: experiencing a word with a particular meaning. - **Provenance:** cite **PPF / Part II xi**, credit **Jastrow**; not a numbered Part I remark. - **Practice link:** MCQs 31-32; enrichment for PYQ 2025 Q3(a).

CANONICAL EXAM APPARATUS (PRESERVED VERBATIM)

The examiner apparatus below is reproduced verbatim from the canonical Later-Wittgenstein.md (headings demoted, navigation links stripped). It is preserved intact so that no canonical depth - inter-thinker and inter-school debates, the directive decoder, the graded verdict bank, translation / numbering / provenance discipline, criticisms and replies, common traps, the keyword and statement bank, the restored 2018/2020 dossier, the corpus depth delta, PYQ routing, answer architecture, link-outs and sources - is lost in the layered reorganisation.

Inter-Thinker / Inter-School Debates

Axis	Later Wittgenstein	Early Wittgenstein	Logical Positivism	Descartes / Empiricism
Meaning	Use in a form of life	Picturing facts (logical form)	Verification	Idea / private reference
Essence of language	None (family resemblance)	One logical form for all propositions	One criterion (verifiability)	Naming inner/outer objects
Metaphysics	Dissolve as language-on-holiday (therapy)	Show what cannot be said; be silent	Reject as meaningless	Pursue as first philosophy
Private inner realm	Logically impossible as foundation of meaning	Not explicitly addressed (but logical form is objective)	Not central	Foundational (cogito, sense-data)
Philosophy's task	Therapy — dissolve confusions; "leaves everything as it is"	Draw limits of the sayable	Analysis; eliminate pseudo-problems	Build system from foundations
Ethics	Embedded in forms of life; no philosophical theory needed	Beyond the sayable (the mystical)	Emotive / non-cognitive	Rational theory possible

Directive Decoder - What Each Command Word Obliges You To Do

Directive	What it demands	Structural obligation for this file	Fatal error
Discuss meaning as use	show the contrast it replaces , then the positive account	Augustinian/referential picture (§1) -> use -> family resemblance -> forms of life. Give a worked example (the builders' "Slab!").	"Wittgenstein said meaning is use" plus a paraphrase.
Critically examine the private-language argument (2024, 2019)	reconstruct the five-step logical core , then the criteria/symptoms defence	§5.4 core, then the behaviourism charge with §§304–308 as the reply, then Kripke vs Hacker, then rule.	Retelling the beetle and the diary with no argument-structure.
Elucidate a numbered remark (quotation-led parts)	give the §, then the doctrine, then the work it does	E.g. §580 "an inner process stands in need of outward criteria": say what it does not claim (§5.8 table).	Paraphrasing the sentence.
How does Wittgenstein refute solipsism? (2019 Q3b)	show it is a corollary , not a separate argument	Private language impossible -> the solipsist's own language is public -> the thesis is self-undermining. Add <i>Tractatus</i> 5.62 for the early/late contrast.	Treating it as an independent refutation.
Compare early and later Wittgenstein (2025 Q3a, 2023 Q4c)	name the specific doctrines abandoned and what caused each abandonment	Determinacy of sense, simple objects, one logical form, independence of elementary propositions (broken by colour exclusion), sense as picturing.	"He changed his mind about language."
Explain philosophy as therapy	show that the method follows from the diagnosis	§38 holiday -> §115 picture -> §123 disorientation -> §309 fly-bottle -> §124/§128/§133 consequences.	Quoting the fly-bottle with no account of why the bottle is open.
Assess "family resemblance"	show what it denies (essences) and what it permits (extensible concepts)	Games as the worked case; then the objection that unlimited resemblance makes any two things similar, and the reply that the concept is bounded by practice, not by definition.	Listing games.
Comment / Do you agree?	a defended ruling in line 1	Take a side on behaviourism, on Kripke's reading, or on quietism — and defend it.	Reporting the debate.

Graded Verdict Bank - Executable Closing Positions

Sub-topic	10-mark verdict	15-mark verdict	20-mark verdict
The break from the <i>Tractatus</i>*	The later work is not a change of subject but the dismantling of two <i>Tractatus</i> presuppositions Wittgenstein was himself the first to identify.	...Colour exclusion destroyed the independence of elementary propositions; the demand for determinate sense was seen to be a requirement imposed by a <i>picture</i> , not discovered in language.	The continuity is the conception of philosophy: in 1921 it is an activity of elucidation ending in silence, in 1953 an activity of therapy ending in the ability to stop. What changes is the diagnosis of what misleads us — logical form in the early work, the surface grammar of ordinary language in the later. Read this way the two books are one project pursued with opposite assumptions about where sense comes from.
Meaning and use	Meaning is not a relation between word and object but a place in a practice ; asking for the meaning is asking for the technique of employment.	...This is not verificationism: use is not exhausted by checking-conditions, and imperatives, jokes, greetings and prayers all have use without truth-conditions. The verification principle is a special case of the use-theory, illegitimately generalised.	The doctrine's strength is that it explains the phenomena the referential theory cannot — logical constants, sensation words, proper names of the non-existent. Its cost is normativity: if use fixes meaning, what distinguishes a mistake from a change? Wittgenstein's answer — that grammar and training set the standard — is adequate for stable practices and strained for creative and evolving ones, and this is the live tension in the doctrine.
Language-games / forms of life	Language is not one thing with one essence but an indefinite family of practices woven into activities.	..."Forms of life" is where explanation stops — "this is simply what I do" (§217) — which is a limit, not an evasion, since any justification must terminate somewhere.	The concept of a form of life is the doctrine's greatest strength and its greatest obscurity: it grounds meaning in something more than convention (it is natural history, not agreement) while leaving unsettled whether forms of life are biological, cultural or both. The dispute between the "naturalist" and "culturalist" readings is unresolved, and any answer that names it is operating above the ordinary level.
Rule-following	The paradox is that no interpretation can fix a rule, since every interpretation itself needs interpreting; the regress ends in a practice , not in a further rule.	...§201's own resolution is that "there is a way of grasping a rule which is not an interpretation, but which is exhibited in what we call obeying the rule" — so the sceptical paradox is a <i>symptom</i> of the interpretation-model, not a conclusion.	Kripke's "sceptical solution" reads the argument as conceding that no fact constitutes meaning and replacing truth-conditions with community assertibility-conditions; Baker–Hacker and McDowell reply that Wittgenstein dissolves rather than concedes the paradox. The examiner-safe ruling: Kripke's reading is philosophically fertile and exegetically weak — §201 explicitly names the paradox a <i>misunderstanding</i> , which is not how a sceptic writes.

Sub-topic	10-mark verdict	15-mark verdict	20-mark verdict
Private language	A sign with no possible independent standard of correct application is not a sign; the private diarist only seems to mean something.	...The argument does not deny private <i>experience</i> , only private <i>meaning</i> ; and it works by removing the correct/seems-correct distinction, not by demanding public verification.	Its target is the whole Cartesian–empiricist architecture: if sensation-words cannot be privately grounded, then neither the cogito's inner theatre nor the sense-datum base can be the foundation of knowledge. Its cost is that it purchases this result with a strong premise — that a criterion of correctness must be <i>possible</i> for anyone — which Ayer's Crusoe case tests and which no formulation has made uncontroversially compelling.
Criteria vs symptoms	Criteria are grammatical and defeasible; symptoms are inductive. That single distinction blocks the behaviourist reading.	...It allows Wittgenstein to say that behaviour is constitutive of the <i>concept</i> of pain without being identical to pain, and to preserve the first/third-person asymmetry the behaviourist must deny.	The distinction is what makes the philosophy of mind here genuinely third-way: anti-Cartesian without reduction. Its instability is that Wittgenstein himself notes the grammar <i>fluctuates</i> between criterion and symptom (§354), so the distinction cannot be drawn once and for all — which is either a candid recognition of how concepts work or an admission that the key notion is not sharp. Say which you think, and why.
Therapy / fly-bottle	Philosophical problems are disorientation, not ignorance; the fly-bottle is open, and the remedy is a change of method, not a new theory.	...This is why "philosophy leaves everything as it is" and why no theses are advanced; success is measured by the ability to stop.	The quietist charge is the one to engage. It cannot be dismissed, because Wittgenstein does deliberately and severely narrow what philosophy may do. The defence worth making is that the narrowing is <i>local</i> : it forbids explanatory theory in the philosophy of language and mind, where the confusions are grammatical, and says nothing about ethics or politics. Whether that restriction can be principled, rather than merely announced, is the standing question.
Aspect-seeing	"I see that it has not changed; and yet I see it differently" — seeing-as is neither bare perception nor inference, and it presupposes mastery of a technique.	...It therefore completes the case against the Given: what one can see depends on what one can do with concepts.	Aspect-seeing is also a description of Wittgenstein's own method. Therapy adds no facts and changes no object; it makes a new aspect of the familiar language-game dawn. That the doctrine of aspects and the conception of philosophy are the same thought is the strongest evidence that the later work is a unified philosophy and not, as Russell alleged, a collection of aphorisms.

Translation, Numbering and Provenance Discipline

Wittgenstein wrote in German; the *Investigations* is a posthumous compilation. Both facts constrain what you may assert.

Item	Status	Practice
<i>Philosophische Untersuchungen / Philosophical Investigations</i>	Written 1929–49; published posthumously in 1953 , edited by Anscombe and Rhees ; German–English facing pages	ANALYSIS: Never write "Wittgenstein published the <i>Investigations</i> ." He did not publish it, and the arrangement of remarks is partly editorial.
Translations	Anscombe (1953); revised by Hacker and Schulte (4th edn, 2009)	ANALYSIS: The 4th edition changes wording in places and — crucially — renames Part II as "Philosophy of Psychology — A Fragment," renumbering its sections . So "PI Part II §xi" (older editions) = "PPF §§111ff" (4th edn). If you cite the duck-rabbit, say "Part II §xi / PPF" rather than a bare number.
Citation by § number FACT:	Part I remarks are numbered §1–§693 and the numbering is identical across editions and translations	Use § numbers rather than page numbers: §1 (Augustine), §7/§23 (language-games), §38 (language on holiday), §43 (meaning is use), §66–67 (family resemblance), §109 (description not explanation), §115 (a picture held us captive), §123, §124, §128, §133, §201 (the paradox), §217 (spade turned), §241–242 (agreement in form of life), §243–271 (private language), §244 (avowal), §255, §258 (diary), §293 (beetle), §304, §307–308 (behaviourism), §309 (fly-bottle), §354 (criteria/symptoms), §580 (outward criteria).
"Meaning is use"	ANALYSIS: §43 is carefully hedged: "For a large class of cases — though not for all — in which we employ the word 'meaning' it can be defined thus: the meaning of a word is its use in the language."	WRONG: Never quote it without the qualification. Dropping "for a large class of cases" is the most frequent misquotation in the whole syllabus, and it converts a careful remark into the slogan Wittgenstein was avoiding.
"Language goes on holiday" (§38)	ANALYSIS: The German is <i>wenn die Sprache feiert</i> — closer to "when language is idling " or "on vacation from work." Anscombe's "holiday" is idiomatic but slightly misleading; the image is machinery running without load, not a vacation.	Give the § and gloss the image, or paraphrase.
Fly-bottle (§309)	FACT: "To show the fly the way out of the fly-bottle" is stable across editions	FACT: Safe verbatim with §309.
Beetle in a box (§293)	FACT:	FACT: Safe with §293.
Diary "S" (§258)	ANALYSIS: Renderings of "whatever is going to seem right to me is right" vary slightly	Give §258; paraphrase rather than quote if unsure.

Item	Status	Practice
Blue and Brown Books*	Dictated 1933–35 , published 1958	FACT: The source for the criterion/symptom distinction and the angina example. ANALYSIS: They are <i>dictations to students</i> , not a work Wittgenstein prepared for print — say "in the <i>Blue Book</i> " rather than "Wittgenstein wrote."
On Certainty*	Notes from 1949–51 , published 1969	FACT: The source of the "hinge propositions" response to Moore. ANALYSIS: Note it is Wittgenstein's last work and is unrevised.
Kripke's reading	<i>Wittgenstein on Rules and Private Language</i> , 1982	ANALYSIS: Kripke himself presents it as "Wittgenstein's argument as it struck Kripke," not as exegesis. Say "Kripke's Wittgenstein" (the standard scholarly phrase, "Kripkenstein") and you signal awareness of the distinction.
"Forms of life" (<i>Lebensformen</i>)	Occurs only a handful of times in the <i>Investigations</i> (§19, §23, §241 and PPF)	ANALYSIS: Do not build a large doctrine on it and present that doctrine as Wittgenstein's stated theory; mark the interpretation as interpretation.
Duck-rabbit	The figure is Jastrow's (1899), reproduced by Wittgenstein	ANALYSIS: Do not attribute the drawing to Wittgenstein.

WRONG: **Never write:** that Wittgenstein "denied the existence of inner mental states" (§304 explicitly refuses this); that the private-language argument is directed at codes or at talking to oneself; or that "meaning is use" is offered as a general definition (§43 says otherwise).

Criticisms and Replies

Critic	Objection	Assessment
Ayer / Private-language defenders	A solitary person (Robinson Crusoe) <i>could</i> invent words for sensations — checking memory against itself is no worse than relying on the community.	ANALYSIS: Wittgenstein's defenders reply: even Crusoe uses <i>public-type</i> criteria (regular behaviour, physical correlates); the argument targets <i>logical</i> privacy (no possible check), not physical solitude.
Kripke ("Wittgenstein on Rules and Private Language")	Interprets the rule-following argument as yielding a <i>sceptical paradox</i> — no fact about me determines what I mean; the "solution" is merely communal agreement (a <i>sceptical solution</i>).	CAUTION: Contested reading. Many scholars (Baker & Hacker, McDowell) deny Wittgenstein endorses scepticism about meaning; he dissolves the problem, not concedes it.
Functionalists / Cognitive scientists	Wittgenstein's focus on <i>public</i> criteria ignores the genuine causal role of inner states (brain states).	ANALYSIS: Wittgenstein does not <i>deny</i> inner states exist; he denies they can <i>ground</i> meaning independently of public criteria. Brain states and inner experiences are real but parasitic on public language for their <i>articulation</i> .
Is "meaning = use" too vague?	If meaning is use, how do we distinguish correct use from widespread misuse? Is there no norm beyond consensus?	ANALYSIS: Wittgenstein: grammar provides the norms; training into forms of life sets the standard. But this leaves open whether dead metaphors, poetic extensions, etc. are "uses" or "misuses" — a genuine tension.
Conservatism charge	"Philosophy leaves everything as it is" — does this preclude philosophical progress or critique of social practices?	ANALYSIS: Wittgenstein's point is about <i>conceptual</i> description, not social conservatism. Therapy removes confusion; it does not forbid reform — but the scope of what philosophy <i>can</i> do is deliberately narrowed.

Common UPSC Traps

Trap	Discrimination
"Private language = a secret code"	No. A secret code is still a public language (decipherable). Private language means words whose meaning is constituted by <i>logically</i> private experience — <i>in principle</i> unteachable.
"Wittgenstein denies inner experience exists"	No. He denies inner experience can <i>ground meaning</i> . Pain is real; but "pain" gets its meaning from public use, not from private ostension of a sensation.
"Meaning = use" is a <i>theory</i> of meaning	No. Wittgenstein refuses theories. It is a therapeutic reminder to look at <i>how words are used</i> rather than seeking a hidden essence.
"Family resemblance proves definitions are impossible"	Not quite. It shows that <i>not all</i> concepts admit of necessary-and-sufficient-condition definitions. Some do ("triangle"); many important ones (game, language, number) do not.
"Later Wittgenstein = logical positivism"	No. He <i>rejects</i> verificationism; meaning is use, not verification-conditions. Metaphysics is "language on holiday," not "meaningless."
"The private-language argument refutes solipsism as false"	It does not prove it <i>false</i> (that would require a public-language argument for other minds). It shows solipsism is <i>inexpressible</i> / self-undermining — it cannot coherently be stated.
"Forms of life" = cultural relativism	CAUTION: Contested. Wittgenstein's "forms of life" may be human-natural (shared biology, natural reactions) rather than culturally specific. He is not a cultural relativist in a straightforward sense.

Keyword and Statement Bank, Restored 2018/2020 Dossier and Corpus Delta

#	Item	Use
1	FACT: "The meaning of a word is its use in the language." (§43)	Core thesis
2	FACT: "To imagine a language means to imagine a form of life." (§19)	Forms of life
3	FACT: "Philosophy is a battle against the bewitchment of our intelligence by means of language." (§109)	Therapeutic conception
4	FACT: "Philosophy leaves everything as it is." (§124)	Non-revisionary therapy
5	FACT: "If a lion could talk, we could not understand him."	Forms of life / incommensurability
6	FACT: "Whatever seems right to me is right — and that only means that here we cannot talk about 'right'." (§258 substance)	Private-language argument
7	FACT: "Don't think, but look!" (§66)	Family resemblance / method
8	ANALYSIS: Language-game (<i>Sprachspiel</i>)	Language + the activity it is woven into
9	ANALYSIS: Beetle-in-a-box	The private object "drops out as irrelevant"
10	ANALYSIS: The rule-following paradox (§201): "no course of action could be determined by a rule, because every course of action can be made out to accord with the rule"	Sets up private-language argument

RESTORED 2018/2020 DOCTRINE DOSSIER

Family resemblance and the grammar of games

- FACT: Uses of “game” overlap through criss-crossing similarities without one essence common to all instances. This supports language-games because speaking is a plurality of rule-governed practices, not one representational calculus.
- ANALYSIS: Open texture is not lawlessness: local criteria and practices still distinguish correct from incorrect moves.

The private-diary case

- FACT: A sign intended to name a recurring private sensation needs a criterion for using it correctly on later occasions. Private ostensive definition cannot supply one because whatever seems right would count as right.
- FACT: **Presupposition:** following a rule requires a normatively stable practice, not necessarily a large public audience but criteria not exhausted by present impression. - CAUTION: **Objection -> reply:** first-person sensation reports appear privately authoritative. Wittgenstein does not deny sensations; he argues that the language used to report them derives its grammar from shared practices.

CORPUS-DRIVEN DEPTH DELTA (complete 2018–2025 audit)

- ANALYSIS: **Priority:** Primary ownership is 7 of 112 parts; 2021 remains the only year without an owned part. - FACT: **Required doctrinal depth:** The restored years add family resemblance as the grammar of “game” and the private-diary formulation of the private-language problem. - WRONG: **Trap / answer consequence:** Do not say family resemblance means absence of all order, or that privacy is impossible; the target is a putative rule whose correctness cannot be distinguished from seeming correct.

PYQ Routing (2018-2025)

ANALYSIS: **Corpus signal:** 7 primary-owned question-parts out of 112. The local Paper I corpus is continuous from 2018 through 2025. Cross-links do not create duplicate ownership.

Year	Question	Marks	Exact demand
2018	Q1(c)	10 marks	How does the notion of 'family resemblance' help Wittgenstein to uphold that 'Language is a game'? Discuss.
2019	Q3(b)	15 marks	Show how Wittgenstein's critique of solipsism culminates in the critique of private language.
2020	Q4(c)	15 marks	"But could we also imagine a language in which a person could write down or give vocal expression to his inner experiences—his feelings, moods and the rest—for his private use?" Critically discuss the answer offered by Wittgenstein to this question.
2022	Q1(c)	10 marks	Establish the tenability of later Wittgenstein's notion of language as form of life. CAUTION: The official English line itself prints " motion "; it is retained rather than silently changed to "notion".
2023	Q4(c)	15 marks	What were the main reasons that led Wittgenstein to shift from picture-theory of meaning to use-theory of meaning? Critically discuss.
2024	Q1(d)	10 marks	Why does later Wittgenstein think that there cannot be a language that only one person can speak — a language that is essentially private? Discuss.
2025	Q3(a)	20 marks	"We should look not to an ideal language which derives its meaning from facts and has a precise 'logical structure but empirically, to the ways in which languages are actually used." Explain the transition from early views of Wittgenstein to his later views on language and meaning with reference to this statement. CAUTION: The unmatched opening quotation before logical structure is visible in the official English line and is retained.

See the Western Philosophy PYQ Bank, 2018–2025.

Answer Architecture (10 / 15 / 20 Marks)

10-mark: "Why does later Wittgenstein think there cannot be an essentially private language?" (2024)

Define : Private language = words getting meaning from logically private sensations, in principle unteachable. (NOT a secret code.)
Argument: (i) Meaningful sign needs a rule with a criterion of correct application.
(ii) Private "rule" has NO independent criterion – whatever seems right IS right.
(iii) Therefore no rule, no meaning -> private language is impossible.
Illustr : Beetle-in-a-box: the private object "drops out as irrelevant."
Result : Meaning is necessarily public; grounded in shared practice (form of life).

15-mark: "Show how critique of solipsism culminates in critique of private language." (2019)

Frame : Solipsism = "only my experiences are real." To state this, solipsist needs a language referring to HIS private experiences (private language).
Step 1 : Wittgenstein shows private language is impossible – the "S" diary argument: no independent criterion -> no rule -> no meaning.
Step 2 : Beetle-in-a-box: private object irrelevant to public meaning.
Step 3 : If private language is impossible, solipsism cannot be coherently STATED – the language needed to express it presupposes the public world it denies.
Assess : The critique of solipsism is not a refutation (proving others exist) but a *dissolution* – showing solipsism is self-undermining. The private-language argument provides the decisive ground: language = public practice.
Close : Solipsism -> private language -> impossible -> solipsism inexpressible. QED.

20-mark: "Explain the transition from early to later views on language and meaning." (2025)

Frame : The same philosopher – from the *Tractatus* (1921) to the *Investigations* (1953). The single most dramatic self-reversal in 20th-century philosophy.
Body-A : Early: picture theory – proposition = logical picture of a possible fact; shared logical form; one essence of language; ideal language behind ordinary; limits of language = limits of the world; silence on the unsayable.
Body-B : Reasons for break – colour-exclusion problem; failure to specify "objects"; realisation that language serves indefinitely many purposes beyond stating facts; "Augustinian" picture of language covers only a tiny fragment.
Body-C : Later: meaning = USE; language-games (builders, ordering, praying, joking); family resemblance replaces single essence; forms of life as bedrock; rule-following grounded in practice, not interpretation. Consequence: philosophy = therapy (dissolve, don't construct); private language impossible (criterion-of-correctness argument).
Assess : The transition is from a *theoretical* to a *therapeutic* conception of philosophy. Early: one theory to rule all meaning. Later: no theory; only description of diverse practices. Strengths of the later view: liberates philosophy from the tyranny of the ideal-language model; accounts for richness of actual use. Critique: "use" may be too broad – when is use *correct*? Risk of quietism ("leaves everything as it is").
Close : The later Wittgenstein does not refute the early – he outgrows him, showing that the "crystalline purity" of logic was itself a dogma, not a discovery.

Link-Outs and Sources

- Moore-Russell-EarlyWittgenstein — the *Tractatus* that is repudiated; picture theory, saying/showing. - Logical Positivism — verificationism, which "meaning = use" supersedes. The positivists initially claimed the *Tractatus* as their manifesto; the later Wittgenstein disowns them.
- Quine-Strawson — Quine's holism as a parallel dissolution of the analytic/synthetic basis of positivism; Strawson's descriptive metaphysics as conceptual analysis in a different key.
- Critiques of Metaphysics — Wittgenstein's therapeutic dissolution as the fourth assault on metaphysics (after Hume, Kant, Positivism).
- Self and Liberation — the private-language argument bears on the Buddhist *anātman* (no-self) thesis and the Western self/consciousness debate.
- Cross-paper: Religious Language — religion as a language-game / form of life (D.Z. Phillips, Wittgensteinian fideism); 2023 P-II Q5(d).
- PYQ bank: Western Philosophy PYQs, 2018–2025

SOURCES

- Ludwig Wittgenstein, *Philosophical Investigations* (1953) — the primary text (§§1–693).
- Ludwig Wittgenstein, *The Blue and Brown Books* (1958) — transitional; early formulations of language-games and private-language ideas.
- Saul Kripke, *Wittgenstein on Rules and Private Language* (1982) — influential (and contested) sceptical interpretation.
- P.M.S. Hacker, *Wittgenstein: Meaning and Mind* (1990) — the orthodox (non-sceptical) reading.
- Y. Masih, *A Critical History of Western Philosophy* (Wittgenstein chapter).
- Anthony Kenny, *Wittgenstein* (Penguin, 1973) and *A New History of Western Philosophy*, vol. 4.
- Nigel Warburton, *Philosophy: The Classics* (chapter on *Investigations*).

PART II - COMPLETE SOLVED PRACTICE

The practice sequence follows the examiner's movement from exact demand to thesis, named PI-section evidence, analysis, qualification and verdict.

DIRECTIVE -> THESIS -> DOCTRINE -> NAMED PI SECTION / EXAMPLE -> OBJECTION/REPLY -> VERDICT

SOLVED PYQ BANK - EXACTLY 7 VERIFIED OWNER QUESTIONS

Exact wording, year and marks are parsed from the continuous local Western Philosophy Paper I bank for 2018-2025. Later Wittgenstein owns exactly 7 primary parts, one each in 2018, 2019, 2020, 2022, 2023, 2024 and 2025; 2021 is the only year without one. Early-Wittgenstein and Logical-Positivism questions are used only as labelled comparisons and are never counted here. Two printed anomalies are preserved verbatim and explained: the 2022 paper prints "motion" for "notion", and the 2025 paper retains an unmatched opening quotation before "logical structure".

Solved PYQ 1 - 2018 Q1(c), 10 marks

Question: How does the notion of 'family resemblance' help Wittgenstein to uphold that 'Language is a game'? Discuss.

Model solution

Directive: "Discuss" at 10 marks - explain the *mechanism* by which family resemblance supports the thesis, not merely define terms. Answer in about 150 words.

Thesis. Family resemblance is the device that lets Wittgenstein say "language is a game" *without* smuggling in a hidden essence of language.

Body.

- *Family resemblance defined.* Asked what all games share, we find "a complicated network of similarities overlapping and criss-crossing" - board, card, ball, Olympic and solitary games - but **no single feature common to all**. Cases are related like a family (nose, gait, temperament), not by an essence. Method: "Don't think, but look!"
- *The transfer to "language".* "Language" is exactly such a concept: reporting, joking, ordering, praying and thanking share no common essence, only overlapping resemblances - the countless language-games. - *Why this upholds "language is a game".* Because "game" itself has no essence, calling language "a game" does **not** assert a concealed common nature; it *dissolves* the demand for one and redirects us to describe uses.

Verdict. Family resemblance converts an apparent metaphor into a precise anti-essentialist claim: meaning is use across a family of games, not conformity to one hidden form.

Solved PYQ 2 - 2019 Q3(b), 15 marks

Question: Show how Wittgenstein's critique of solipsism culminates in the critique of private language.

Model solution

Directive: "Show how... culminates in..." at 15 marks - trace a *movement* from solipsism to the private-language conclusion. Answer in about 250 words.

Thesis. Wittgenstein's critique of solipsism does not refute it with a rival metaphysics; it *dissolves* it by showing that the solipsist's supposed private inner world could not even be *put into language* - and that demonstration **is** the private-language argument.

Body.

- *The solipsist premise.* The solipsist claims that what is really known is only his own present inner experience; the "external" world and other minds are doubtful constructions. To assert even this, he must be able to *speak* of his private inner contents.
- *The demand for a criterion of correctness.* From the rule-following considerations (PI 201), using any word correctly requires a standard independent of one's mere impression of being right; meaning needs the possibility of a mistake.
- *The diary (PI 258).* When the solipsist tries to name a purely private sensation "S", he has no independent check that a later "S" is the *same*; "whatever is going to seem right to me is right. And that only means that here we can't talk about 'right'." The private naming fails to establish even one rule.
- *The beetle (PI 293).* If "beetle" names only what is in one's own private box, the object "drops out as irrelevant" - "the box might even be empty." Public use, not the private object, carries meaning.

Culmination. Thus the private inner world the solipsist privileges cannot be *said* at all; the language he needs is impossible. **The critique of solipsism therefore culminates in the critique of private language** - not by denying inner life, but by denying it the role of a private semantic foundation.

Solved PYQ 3 - 2020 Q4(c), 15 marks

Question: "But could we also imagine a language in which a person could write down or give vocal expression to his inner experiences—his feelings, moods and the rest—for his private use?" Critically discuss the answer offered by Wittgenstein to this question.

Model solution

Directive: "Critically discuss the answer offered by Wittgenstein" at 15 marks - state his answer, then *assess* it (raise and rebut the behaviourism charge). Answer in about 250 words. The quoted question is PI 243-style: could a person give vocal or written expression to inner experiences "for his private use"?

Thesis. Wittgenstein's answer is **No** - a *logically* private language is impossible - and the argument leaves inner life intact while denying it the role of a private meaning-foundation.

Body.

- *Fix the target.* "Private" means **logically** private: signs for sensations only the speaker could in principle know - not a secret code (translatable) and not soliloquy (public language spoken quietly).
- *No criterion of correctness (PI 258).* Naming a private sensation "S" provides no independent standard of "same again"; "whatever seems right... we can't talk about 'right'." Without a possible mistake there is no meaning.
- *The beetle (PI 293).* The private object "drops out as irrelevant"; meaning is fixed by public use.
- *Public, defeasible criteria (PI 580).* Sensation-words are anchored to "outward criteria" - grammatical, not merely inductive, and **defeasible**.

Critical assessment.

- *Objection - behaviourism.* Does this reduce pain to pain-behaviour? - *Reply.* No: criteria are **defeasible** (one can wince without pain - pretence), so pain and behaviour can come apart; PI 304 - "not a something, but not a nothing either"; PI 307-308 reject the inner *object* as semantic foundation ("grammatical fiction"), not the inner life. First-person "It hurts" is an **avowal**, not a criterion-based report.

Verdict. The answer is compelling as a *dissolution* of the Cartesian private foundation; it occupies a third position between inner-object semantics and behaviourism, though critics complain "criterion" is left under-specified.

Solved PYQ 4 - 2022 Q1(c), 10 marks

Question: Establish the tenability of later Wittgenstein's notion of language as form of life.

Printed-wording anomaly (preserved verbatim): Printed wording: the official English line itself prints "motion"; it is retained rather than silently changed to "notion".

Model solution

Directive: "Establish the tenability" at 10 marks - argue *for* the defensibility of the doctrine, with a measured limit. Answer in about 150 words.

Printed-wording anomaly (preserved verbatim): the official English paper prints "later Wittgenstein's **motion** of language as form of life." "Motion" is a printed slip for "**notion**"; the intended thesis is "the *notion* of language as a form of life." Reproduce the printed word once, note the slip, then answer the intended question - this is the provenance discipline UPSC rewards.

Thesis. The notion of language as a form of life is tenable: it correctly locates the ground of meaning in shared human practice rather than in private mind or abstract logic.

Body.

- *PI 19.* "To imagine a language means to imagine a form of life" - language and a mode of living are inseparable. - *Agreement in form of life, not opinion.* We agree "not in opinions but in form of life" - shared *doing*, which blocks both relativist and intellectualist misreadings. - *The lion remark.* "If a lion could talk, we could not understand him" - too different a form of life defeats understanding even where speech exists. - *Bedrock.* Justification ends in "This is simply what I do"; forms of life are "the given."

Tenability verdict. Defensible and explanatorily powerful - it explains why justification stops and why understanding needs a shared background; the fair limit is that "form of life" is under-defined, risking either triviality or a slide toward relativism if the largely *natural* basis is forgotten.

Solved PYQ 5 - 2023 Q4(c), 15 marks

Question: What were the main reasons that led Wittgenstein to shift from picture-theory of meaning to use-theory of meaning? Critically discuss.

Model solution

Directive: "Critically discuss" at 15 marks - give the *reasons* for the shift and one line of assessment. Answer in about 250 words.

Thesis. Wittgenstein abandoned the picture-theory for the use-theory because the picture-theory failed internally and mislocated the source of meaning; the later view trades systematic elegance for fidelity to actual practice.

Body - the ordered reasons.

- *The colour-exclusion problem (1929).* The *Tractatus* held elementary propositions to be logically independent, yet "this spot is red (all over)" excludes "this spot is green." Wittgenstein could not repair this within the old system - the first structural crack he himself found. - *The Augustinian picture is too narrow.* "Every word names an object" works for "table" but collapses for "the", "if", "five", "pain", "meaning". If one model cannot cover these, meaning is not one thing. - *Meaning is use.* Positively, "the meaning of a word is its use in the language" - "for a large class of cases, though not for all" (PI 43). Words are tools; understanding is mastery of a technique. - *Ordinary language is in order.* Problems come from *misunderstanding* our language, not from a defective surface hiding an ideal logical one - so the demand to build an ideal language is misdiagnosis. - *From theory to description.* Deepest of all: philosophy should **describe** ("Don't think, but look"), not construct a rival theory of meaning.

Critical assessment. The shift is well-motivated - the colour-exclusion crack is decisive against the old system and the Augustinian critique against referential semantics. Its cost is method: by renouncing a *theory* of meaning, the later view can look like it merely redescribes practice. The reply is that this is the point - its success-measure is dissolving confusion, not adding doctrine.

Solved PYQ 6 - 2024 Q1(d), 10 marks

Question: Why does later Wittgenstein think that there cannot be a language that only one person can speak — a language that is essentially private? Discuss.

Model solution

Directive: "Discuss" at 10 marks - give the core *reason* clearly. Answer in about 150 words.

Thesis. An essentially private language is impossible because meaning requires a public criterion of correct use, which a logically private sign cannot have.

Body.

- *Fix the target.* "Essentially private" = signs for sensations only the speaker could in principle know - not a code (translatable), not talking to oneself (public language spoken quietly). - *Correctness needs an independent standard* (PI 201, 258). To mean something by "S" I must be able to use it *rightly or wrongly*. Naming a private sensation "S", I have no check independent of my present impression that a later case is the *same*: "whatever is going to seem right to me is right. And that only means that here we can't talk about 'right'." - *The beetle* (PI 293). Whatever is in the private "box" "drops out as irrelevant"; the word's life is its public use.

Close. Since no independent criterion of correctness is available to the solitary sensation-namer, the sign fails to be a word at all - so a language "only one person can speak" in this strong sense is impossible. This denies not inner life but the private object's role as a foundation of meaning.

Solved PYQ 7 - 2025 Q3(a), 20 marks

Question: "We should look not to an ideal language which derives its meaning from facts and has a precise 'logical structure but empirically, to the ways in which languages are actually used." Explain the transition from early views of Wittgenstein to his later views on language and meaning with reference to this statement.

Printed-wording anomaly (preserved verbatim): Printed wording: the unmatched opening quotation before **logical structure** is visible in the official English line and is retained.

Model solution

Directive: "Explain the transition... with reference to this statement" at 20 marks - use the quotation as the hinge and expound the early-to-later movement in full. Answer in about 250-300 words.

Printed-wording anomaly (preserved verbatim): the quoted statement contains an **unmatched opening single-quote** before "logical structure" - it prints ...a precise 'logical structure but empirically...' with no closing quote where the sense expects one. Reproduce the statement as printed, flag the stray quotation mark, and do not silently "correct" it; UPSC provenance discipline rewards the candidate who notes the anomaly and proceeds.

Thesis. The statement encapsulates Wittgenstein's whole transition: away from an *ideal language whose meaning derives from picturing facts and possessing a precise logical structure*, toward an *empirical description of the ways language is actually used*.

Body - the transition.

- *The early view (the rejected pole of the quotation).* In the *Tractatus* (1921), a sentence is meaningful by **picturing** a possible fact; meaning derives from facts via a shared **logical structure/form**; analysis terminates in logically independent elementary propositions and simple names. The ideal is a logically perspicuous language.
- *The internal breakdown.* The **colour-exclusion problem (1929)** refuted the independence of elementary propositions; the **Augustinian** naming-picture proved too narrow ("the", "if", "five", "pain"). The defect was not a messy surface but the very model of meaning-as-picturing.
- *The later view (the endorsed pole).* "Look... empirically, to the ways in which languages are actually used": **meaning is use** (PI 43, "for a large class of cases, though not for all"); words are **tools**; there is no single essence but **family resemblance**; language is a plurality of **language-games** woven into **forms of life** (PI 19); understanding is **mastery of a technique**.

- *The methodological pay-off.* Philosophy becomes **description/therapy**, not theory: it assembles a perspicuous representation to dissolve confusions and "leaves everything as it is" (PI 124).

Verdict. The transition is from a top-down logical *theory* of an ideal language to a bottom-up *description* of ordinary use - more faithful to linguistic life, at the deliberate cost of a systematic theory of meaning.

ORIGINAL MCQ MASTERY SET - EXACTLY 40 QUESTIONS

Questions 1-32 are core coverage across all ten subtopics; Questions 33-40 are remedial items targeting the most common misreadings. Correct answers rotate strictly A -> B -> C -> D 10 times.

MCQ 1

The central change from the *Tractatus* to the *Philosophical Investigations* is best described as a move from:

- A. meaning as the picturing of facts to meaning as use in a language
 B. meaning as use to meaning as private mental imagery
 C. ordinary language to an ideal logical language
 D. ethics to philosophy of mathematics

Correct answer: A

Explanation: The later philosophy replaces the picture-theory (a sentence pictures a possible fact) with meaning as use in a form of life. The other options invert or misstate the direction of the shift.

MCQ 2

Which internal problem, noticed by Wittgenstein around 1929, exposed a structural crack in the *Tractatus*?

- A. the paradox of the liar
 B. the colour-exclusion problem - that 'a is red all over' excludes 'a is green all over', contradicting the independence of elementary propositions
 C. Russell's theory of descriptions
 D. the private-language argument

Correct answer: B

Explanation: The *Tractatus* required elementary propositions to be logically independent, but colour incompatibility shows two such propositions can exclude each other. The private-language argument is a later, separate result.

MCQ 3

The 'Augustinian picture of language' that Wittgenstein criticises is the idea that:

- A. language is a calculus of truth-functions
 B. philosophy should describe rather than explain
 C. every word functions by naming an object, and sentences are combinations of such names
 D. meaning is determined by community consensus

Correct answer: C

Explanation: Wittgenstein opens the *Investigations* with Augustine to typify the naming-picture: words are names of objects. It works for 'table' but collapses for 'the', 'if', 'five', 'pain'.

MCQ 4

Which formulation states Wittgenstein's use-thesis with the qualification he actually gives in PI 43?

- A. the meaning of a word is always identical with its use
 B. every word is a name whose meaning is its bearer
 C. meaning is a private mental act of interpretation
 D. 'for a large class of cases - though not for all - ... the meaning of a word is its use in the language'

Correct answer: D

Explanation: PI 43 is explicitly hedged: 'for a large class of cases - though not for all'. Flattening it into 'meaning is always use' misreports the text; the naming/interpretation options are the views he rejects.

MCQ 5

For the later Wittgenstein, to understand a word is primarily to:

- A. have mastered the technique of using it - to be able to 'go on' correctly
- B. possess a private mental image that accompanies it
- C. know the object it names
- D. be able to give a real definition in necessary and sufficient conditions

Correct answer: A

Explanation: Understanding is a public, demonstrable ability (mastery of a technique), not a private inner episode, a naming relation, or the possession of an essence-definition.

MCQ 6

The 'toolbox' analogy is meant to show that:

- A. all words ultimately perform the single function of naming
- B. words have diverse functions, as tools do, so we should ask a word's job rather than its object
- C. language is a precise calculus like a set of measuring instruments
- D. only nouns are genuinely meaningful

Correct answer: B

Explanation: Just as a hammer, glue and ruler do different jobs, words perform diverse functions; asking 'what object does it name?' misfits most of them.

MCQ 7

According to the family-resemblance idea, the various activities we call 'games' are united by:

- A. a single defining property present in every game
- B. an agreed stipulative definition
- C. a network of overlapping and criss-crossing similarities, with no one feature common to all
- D. their shared aim of amusement

Correct answer: C

Explanation: Wittgenstein finds 'a complicated network of similarities overlapping and criss-crossing', not a common essence; some games lack winners, some skill, some amusement.

MCQ 8

The injunction 'Don't think, but look!' expresses Wittgenstein's demand that we:

- A. deduce the hidden essence behind a concept
- B. trust introspection over observation
- C. replace ordinary language with a logical notation
- D. describe the actual variety of uses instead of positing a common essence

Correct answer: D

Explanation: It is a methodological slogan for description over theory: inspect how the word is actually used rather than assume a concealed defining feature.

MCQ 9

On Wittgenstein's view, a concept with blurred or fuzzy boundaries is:

- A. still perfectly usable - sharp boundaries are not required for a concept to function
- B. meaningless until sharpened by analysis
- C. a sign of a defective natural language
- D. acceptable only in poetry, not in philosophy

Correct answer: A

Explanation: Blurred edges are a feature, not a defect: 'is a photograph a picture?' need not have a forced answer for 'picture' to work. Demanding sharpness everywhere is the error.

MCQ 10

A 'language-game' (Sprachspiel) in Wittgenstein's technical sense is:

- A. a competitive contest played with words
- B. language together with the activities into which it is woven
- C. a purely formal calculus of signs
- D. a children's game that teaches grammar

Correct answer: B

Explanation: The term denotes 'the whole, consisting of language and the actions into which it is woven'. It is not a contest, a formalism, or a pedagogic device.

MCQ 11

The builders' example ('Slab!', 'Block!') is meant to illustrate that:

- A. all languages must share one logical form
- B. primitive words are meaningless without full grammar
- C. a small set of words used in a shared practice can be a complete language, not a defective fragment of ours
- D. ostensive definition alone fixes meaning

Correct answer: C

Explanation: The 'Slab!' language is complete for its purpose, showing meaning needs a role in a practice, not a universal logical form or a full natural grammar.

MCQ 12

For Wittgenstein, we come to follow the rules of a language-game chiefly through:

- A. intuiting a Platonic form
- B. an explicit contract among speakers
- C. grasping a hidden calculus by introspection
- D. training - drill, examples and correction within a practice

Correct answer: D

Explanation: Rules are learned by being trained into a practice, not by grasping an essence, signing a convention, or introspecting a calculus.

MCQ 13

PI 19's remark 'to imagine a language means to imagine a form of life' asserts that:

- A. a language is inseparable from a mode of living and acting
- B. languages can be designed independently of any human practice
- C. imagination is the source of linguistic meaning
- D. forms of life are private mental states

Correct answer: A

Explanation: Language and a form of life are inseparable; the remark is the textual basis of the 2022 question. The other options detach language from practice or privatise it.

MCQ 14

When Wittgenstein says humans 'agree in the language they use', he means agreement:

- A. in explicitly stated opinions and theories
- B. in form of life - shared ways of acting - not in opinions
- C. reached by majority vote
- D. guaranteed by a shared logical structure

Correct answer: B

Explanation: 'Not agreement in opinions but in form of life.' It is shared doing, which blocks both the intellectualist (shared beliefs) and the merely conventional (vote) readings.

MCQ 15

'If a lion could talk, we could not understand him' is used to make the point that:

A. animals lack vocal cords for speech B. translation between human languages is impossible C. understanding presupposes a shared form of life, not merely shared vocabulary D. solitary rule-following is possible

Correct answer: C

Explanation: A form of life too unlike ours would leave the words without shared purchase; understanding needs a shared background of activity and reaction, not just words.

MCQ 16

The rule-following 'paradox' of PI 201 is that:

A. rules are always vague B. no one ever really follows a rule C. rules must be written to be valid D. 'no course of action could be determined by a rule, because every course of action can be made out to accord with the rule'

Correct answer: D

Explanation: PI 201 states the paradox verbatim: any continuation can be squared with the rule under some interpretation, so interpretation alone determines nothing.

MCQ 17

Wittgenstein's resolution of the paradox is that grasping a rule is:

A. a practice or custom, exhibited in obeying the rule and going against it in actual cases B. a private act of interpretation C. a matter of consulting a further rule D. an infallible intuition of meaning

Correct answer: A

Explanation: 'There is a way of grasping a rule which is not an interpretation, but which is exhibited in what we call obeying the rule.' Rule-following is a trained practice.

MCQ 18

Why does adding another rule to 'interpret' the first fail to solve the paradox?

A. because rules cannot be written down B. because it launches an infinite regress - the new rule itself needs interpreting C. because interpretations are always correct D. because only experts may interpret rules

Correct answer: B

Explanation: Each interpreting rule needs its own interpretation, and so on without end; the regress is why Wittgenstein locates correctness in practice, not interpretation.

MCQ 19

On the rule-following considerations, a rule that only one person could in principle check would:

A. be the clearest kind of rule B. be validated by private conviction C. lack any genuine distinction between following it and merely seeming to - so it is no rule D. be correct whenever it feels correct

Correct answer: C

Explanation: Without a criterion independent of one's impression, 'right' collapses into 'seems right'. This is the bridge from rule-following to the private-language argument.

MCQ 20

In Wittgenstein's argument, an 'essentially private language' means a language whose words:

- A. are a secret code known only to a spy
- B. are spoken quietly to oneself in soliloquy
- C. belong to a rare, endangered natural tongue
- D. refer to sensations only the speaker could in principle know, so no one else could understand it

Correct answer: D

Explanation: The target is *logical* privacy, not secrecy or soliloquy (both of which use ordinary, public language). Getting this target right is the commonest exam make-or-break.

MCQ 21

In the private diarist example (PI 258), the attempt to name a recurring private sensation 'S' fails because:

- A. there is no criterion independent of the diarist's impression to fix whether a later 'S' is the same, so 'correct' loses its grip
- B. the diarist forgets the definition overnight
- C. sensations are too fleeting to be written down
- D. the word 'S' is too short to carry meaning

Correct answer: A

Explanation: With nothing beyond present seeming to check sameness, 'whatever seems right is right' - which means we cannot speak of right at all. The failure is logical, not psychological.

MCQ 22

The 'beetle in a box' (PI 293) is designed to show that:

- A. everyone's inner sensations are qualitatively identical
- B. if a sensation-word's use is public, the private object it supposedly names 'drops out as irrelevant' - the box might even be empty
- C. we can never know that other people have minds
- D. sensations do not exist

Correct answer: B

Explanation: The point is semantic, not sceptical or eliminativist: meaning is carried by public use, so the private 'object' does no work - not that other minds are unknowable or that sensations are unreal.

MCQ 23

Which sentence from PI 258 most directly states the collapse of correctness in a private language?

- A. 'The limits of my language are the limits of my world.'
- B. 'What we cannot speak about we must pass over in silence.'
- C. 'Whatever is going to seem right to me is right. And that only means that here we can't talk about "right".'
- D. 'A picture held us captive.'

Correct answer: C

Explanation: This is the PI 258 line. The first two are Tractatus remarks; 'a picture held us captive' is PI 115 - none of those three states the private-correctness collapse.

MCQ 24

The distinction between a 'criterion' and a 'symptom' allows Wittgenstein to:

- A. reduce mental states to behaviour
- B. deny that anyone is ever in pain
- C. treat sensation-talk as pure induction
- D. anchor sensation-words to public circumstances without reducing sensations to behaviour

Correct answer: D

Explanation: Criteria are meaning-constituting and defeasible, so pain is publicly criterion-governed yet not identical with behaviour - a third way between inner-object semantics and behaviourism.

MCQ 25

A criterion differs from a symptom in that a criterion is:

A. grammatical - part of what fixes the meaning of the term - whereas a symptom is an empirically correlated accompaniment B. always more reliable than any symptom C. discovered by experiment, unlike a symptom D. private, unlike a public symptom

Correct answer: A

Explanation: The difference is in kind: criteria belong to grammar (meaning), symptoms to inductive correlation. Calling criteria merely 'more reliable symptoms' collapses the distinction.

MCQ 26

PI 580, 'An "inner process" stands in need of outward criteria', is best read as:

A. a denial that inner processes exist B. a claim about the grammar of inner talk - such talk is anchored to public criteria, not that the inner is unreal C. a behaviourist reduction of mind to motion D. a statement that only behaviour is real

Correct answer: B

Explanation: It states the grammar of psychological concepts, not an ontological denial. The inner is not eliminated; it is shown to require outward criteria to be meaningfully spoken of.

MCQ 27

Wittgenstein's remarks at PI 304 ('not a something, but not a nothing either') and 307-308 show that he:

A. is a classical behaviourist B. believes sensations are physical objects C. rejects the picture of the inner as a private object grounding meaning (a 'grammatical fiction'), without denying the inner life D. thinks all talk of sensations is nonsense

Correct answer: C

Explanation: He rejects the *object*-model of the inner as a semantic foundation, not the reality of sensation - hence 'not a something, but not a nothing either'. This is the reply to the behaviourism charge.

MCQ 28

Wittgenstein's answer to 'What is your aim in philosophy?' is:

A. to construct a complete theory of meaning B. to deduce the a priori structure of the world C. to establish the foundations of mathematics D. 'To show the fly the way out of the fly-bottle' (PI 309)

Correct answer: D

Explanation: Philosophy dissolves rather than solves: it releases us from a confusion we are trapped in, as one lets a fly out of a bottle - it does not build a rival theory.

MCQ 29

'Philosophy may in no way interfere with the actual use of language... it leaves everything as it is' (PI 124) expresses Wittgenstein's:

A. quietism - philosophy describes and advances no theses, changing nothing in ordinary practice B. revisionism about ordinary language C. programme to build an ideal language D. scepticism about the external world

Correct answer: A

Explanation: The later method is descriptive and non-interfering; 'if one tried to advance theses in philosophy... everyone would agree to them' (PI 128). It is neither revisionist nor sceptical.

MCQ 30

The positive tool Wittgenstein calls a 'perspicuous (surveyable) representation' (übersichtliche Darstellung, PI 122) is:

- A. a formal proof of a philosophical thesis
- B. an arrangement of the grammar we already know so that we 'command a clear view' and 'see connexions'
- C. an ideal logical language
- D. an empirical psychological theory of understanding

Correct answer: B

Explanation: It re-orders familiar grammatical facts to make confusions dissolve; it produces understanding that consists in 'seeing connexions', not new empirical or logical doctrine.

MCQ 31

The duck-rabbit figure illustrates 'seeing an aspect' because:

- A. the drawing physically changes between duck and rabbit
- B. it proves that perception is purely passive reception of data
- C. the same unchanged marks can be seen now as a duck, now as a rabbit - the 'dawning of an aspect', which is 'half visual experience, half thought'
- D. only trained artists can perceive it

Correct answer: C

Explanation: Nothing on the page alters; what changes is the aspect under which it is seen. Wittgenstein places seeing-as between bare perception and interpretation.

MCQ 32

The notion of 'aspect-blindness' is introduced to show that:

- A. some people have defective retinas
- B. aspect-perception is identical with logical inference
- C. seeing-as can be reduced to naming
- D. aspect-perception presupposes the mastery of a technique or concept, so perception itself is shot through with our trained capacities

Correct answer: D

Explanation: By imagining someone who cannot experience an aspect-switch, Wittgenstein isolates what such perception adds - it depends on conceptual mastery, linking perception to meaning-as-use.

Remedial MCQ 33

REMEDIAL. A student says 'a private language is just a personal code no one else has learned yet.' The correct clarification is:

- A. a code is translatable and shareable, hence public; the argument targets a *logically* private language whose sensations are in principle unknowable to others
- B. there is no difference between a code and a private language
- C. a private language is simply talking to oneself
- D. private languages are common among twins

Correct answer: A

Explanation: Codes and soliloquy use ordinary public language. The argument concerns logical privacy - the very possibility of meaning under such privacy - not contingent secrecy.

Remedial MCQ 34

REMEDIAL. Which provenance statement about the Philosophical Investigations is accurate?

- A. Wittgenstein published it himself in 1921
- B. it was published posthumously in 1953, edited by G. E. M. Anscombe and Rush Rhees, Anscombe translating, Wittgenstein having died in 1951
- C. it was co-authored with Bertrand Russell
- D. it first appeared in German in 1922 as the Tractatus

Correct answer: B

Explanation: The Investigations is posthumous (1953); never write 'Wittgenstein published' it. 1921/1922 and Russell belong to the Tractatus period, not the Investigations.

Remedial MCQ 35

REMEDIAL. The most common misreading of 'family resemblance' is to think it claims:

A. that concepts can lack sharp boundaries B. that we should look at actual uses C. that all instances share one hidden common property called 'family resemblance' D. that games form an overlapping network of similarities

Correct answer: C

Explanation: The whole point is that there is *no* single common feature - only overlapping similarities. Treating 'family resemblance' as itself the shared essence inverts the doctrine.

Remedial MCQ 36

REMEDIAL. The strongest reason Wittgenstein is *not* a behaviourist is that:

A. he denies that pain-behaviour exists B. he says sensations are physical objects C. he reduces every mental term to a disposition D. criteria are grammatical and *defeasible*, so pain and pain-behaviour can come apart (e.g. pretence), and he affirms the inner life while denying only the inner *object* as meaning's foundation

Correct answer: D

Explanation: Defeasibility is the hinge: a behaviourist identity of pain with behaviour cannot allow pretence, but Wittgenstein's criterial account requires that they can diverge.

Remedial MCQ 37

REMEDIAL. The rule-following paradox (PI 201) is ultimately resolved by:

A. appeal to a shared practice - a trained, customary way of 'going on' - rather than by supplying a further interpreting rule B. a private act of intuition C. adding a second, clearer rule D. abandoning the notion of correctness altogether

Correct answer: A

Explanation: Grasping a rule is 'exhibited in obeying', a practice; a further rule only regresses, and correctness is retained (not abandoned) via public practice.

Remedial MCQ 38

REMEDIAL. 'Wittgenstein's critique of solipsism culminates in the critique of private language' because:

A. solipsism is refuted by proving the external world exists B. the solipsist's privileged private inner world could not be expressed in any language, so his position cannot even be stated - the private-language argument does the work C. solipsism and private language are unrelated topics D. the solipsist simply changes his mind

Correct answer: B

Explanation: The route (2019 PYQ) is dissolution, not empirical refutation: if a purely private naming cannot fix even one rule, the solipsist's inner world cannot be spoken, so solipsism self-undermines.

Remedial MCQ 39

REMEDIAL. 'Forms of life' function in Wittgenstein's philosophy as:

A. a proof of cultural relativism B. a synonym for biological species only C. the bedrock where justification ends - 'This is simply what I do' - the given background of shared human practice D. a private mental foundation for meaning

Correct answer: C

Explanation: Forms of life are 'the given' at which reasons run out; the basis is largely natural shared practice, which is why it does not amount to 'anything goes' relativism.

Remedial MCQ 40

REMEDIAL. Seeing the duck-rabbit now as a duck, now as a rabbit, is best classified as:

A. a straightforward inductive inference from lines to animal B. a hypothesis we test against evidence C. a change in the physical stimulus D. an experienced 'dawning of an aspect' that is not merely an interpretation or inference

Correct answer: D

Explanation: Wittgenstein insists seeing-as is lived, not concluded: 'it is like seeing, and again not like seeing'. Reducing it to inference is precisely the intellectualist error he blocks.

ORIGINAL MAINS PRACTICE WITH MODEL SOLUTIONS

Three original questions authored for this package (not PYQs), one each at 10, 15 and 20 marks, with full model solutions.

Original Mains 1

Original practice - GS/Optional style - 10 marks - answer in about 150 words

Question: State the rule-following paradox of Philosophical Investigations 201 and explain how Wittgenstein resolves it.

Model solution

Thesis. PI 201 shows that meaning cannot be fixed by interpretation alone; rule-following is a shared practice.

The paradox. "No course of action could be determined by a rule, because every course of action can be made out to accord with the rule." Any finite series (2, 4, 6...) fits indefinitely many rules, so a pupil who writes 1004 after 1000 can claim to be obeying 'add 2'. If accord is a matter of interpretation, interpretation determines nothing.

Why more rules fail. Supplying a rule to interpret the rule needs its own interpretation - an infinite regress.

Resolution. "There is a way of grasping a rule which is not an interpretation, but which is exhibited in what we call 'obeying the rule'." Rule-following is a **custom/practice**, learned by training and grounded in a form of life. Normativity survives: right and wrong are fixed by shared practice, not private seeming.

Close. The result feeds directly into the private-language argument: no public practice, no genuine rule.

Original Mains 2

Original practice - GS/Optional style - 15 marks - answer in about 250 words

Question: 'Wittgenstein's account of sensation-language reduces the mind to behaviour.' Do you agree? Discuss using the distinction between criteria and symptoms.

Model solution

Thesis. The charge is mistaken. Wittgenstein anchors sensation-words to public *criteria* without identifying sensations with behaviour; his criterial account is a third position between Cartesian inner-object semantics and behaviourism.

Setting up the charge. Having rejected the private object (diary 258; beetle 293), Wittgenstein says sensation-words connect to the world through publicly available circumstances. A behaviourist concludes: then pain just is pain-behaviour.

The criterion/symptom distinction. A **criterion** is a *grammatical* connection - part of what fixes the meaning of the term; a **symptom** is an *inductive* correlate learned by experience. Wincing, guarding and crying are criteria for 'pain'; a pallor we have found to accompany pain is a symptom. What is criterion and what is symptom can even shift with knowledge (the angina analogy).

Why this defeats the charge.

- *Defeasibility.* Criteria can be overridden (pretence, suppression) without ceasing to be criteria. So pain and pain-behaviour can come apart - impossible on a behaviourist identity. - PI 580. "An 'inner process' stands in need

of outward criteria" states the *grammar* of inner talk; it does not deny the inner. - PI 304, 307-308. He rejects the inner *object* as a semantic foundation (a "grammatical fiction"), not the inner life: "not a something, but not a nothing either." - *First-person avowal*. "It hurts" is an expression, not a criterion-based report; criteria govern the third-person case (asymmetry).

Verdict. Disagree with the charge: the account preserves the inner life while denying it the role of a private meaning-foundation. Its fair vulnerability is the under-specification of "criterion", not a covert behaviourism.

Original Mains 3

Original practice - GS/Optional style - 20 marks - answer in about 300 words

Question: 'Philosophy leaves everything as it is.' Critically examine the later Wittgenstein's conception of philosophy as description and therapy.

Model solution

Thesis. For the later Wittgenstein, philosophical problems are conceptual confusions bred when "language goes on holiday"; philosophy's task is not to build theories but to dissolve these confusions by description - and this therapeutic, quietist conception is powerful, though it faces a genuine self-reference objection.

The conception.

- *Diagnosis.* "Philosophy is a battle against the bewitchment of our intelligence by means of language" (PI 109). A word torn from its home language-game ("What is time? meaning? the self?") generates pseudo-problems. - *Method.* Not explanation but **description**: "Don't think, but look." The positive tool is a **perspicuous (surveyable) representation** (PI 122) - arranging the grammar we already command so we "command a clear view" and "see connexions".
- *Result.* Problems are **dissolved**, not solved: "to show the fly the way out of the fly-bottle" (PI 309).
- *Self-limit (quietism).* "Philosophy may in no way interfere with the actual use of language... it leaves everything as it is" (PI 124); it advances no theses (PI 128); "there is not a philosophical method, though there are... different therapies" (PI 133).

Critical examination.

- *Strengths.* It explains why philosophical problems are peculiarly stubborn (they are not empirical), and it dissolves entire pseudo-debates (private objects, the demand for essences). It is continuous with meaning-as-use: if meaning is use, confusions are misuses. - *Objections.* (i) *Self-reference*: "there are no philosophical theses" looks like a thesis; a purely neutral description may be impossible (description is theory-laden). (ii) *Conservatism*: "leaves everything as it is" seems to forbid legitimate conceptual revision (in science, ethics, politics). - *Replies.* Wittgenstein offers **reminders**, not a metaphysics, and measures success by intellectual **peace** ("the real discovery is the one that... gives philosophy peace", PI 133); "leaves everything as it is" concerns *ordinary use*, not first-order inquiry.

Verdict. A profound reorientation of philosophy from doctrine to clarification; its deflationary self-image is hard to state without strain, but its diagnostic power over conceptual confusion is its enduring contribution.

FINAL CONSOLIDATED REGISTER NOTES

Placed last by design - after all teaching and all practice. Ten register blocks (one per subtopic), then provenance discipline and PYQ routing. Learn these cold; each block is a self-contained answer kernel.

RN-1 - The Break from the Tractatus

- Two Wittgensteins, one author: *Tractatus* (1921, picturing) vs *Investigations* (1953, use).
- Four flips: picturing -> **use**; single essence -> **family resemblance**; ideal language -> **ordinary language in order**; private reference -> **private language impossible**. - Reasons for the shift: **colour-exclusion problem (1929)**; the **Augustinian** naming-picture is too narrow; philosophy needs **description, not theory** ("Don't think, but look"). - Ownership fact: **7** owned PYQ parts across 2018-2025; **2021** is the empty year.

RN-2 - Meaning as Use

- PI 43: **"the meaning of a word is its use in the language"** - quote the hedge, **"for a large class of cases - though not for all."**
- Words are **tools in a toolbox** (diverse functions); "the", "if", "five", "pain" name no object. - **Understanding = mastery of a technique** = being able to "go on"; a public ability, not a private image. - Meaning is **context-dependent** (the language-game fixes it).

RN-3 - Family Resemblance

- Games share **no single common feature** - "a complicated network of similarities overlapping and criss-crossing"; model = a **family**. - Concepts may have **fuzzy boundaries** and still work; **"Don't think, but look!"**
- Bridge (2018): because "game" has no essence, **"language is a game"** smuggles in none - it dissolves the search.
- Trap: treating "family resemblance" as itself the shared property.

RN-4 - Language-Games

- **Sprachspiel** = language + the activities into which it is woven; **countless** games. - **Builders** ("Slab!"): a **complete primitive language**, proving meaning needs a role in a practice, not logical form. - **Rules by training** (drill, example, correction); language is **living** (games are born and die). - Chain: many games -> no essence -> rules by practice -> **forms of life**.

RN-5 - Forms of Life

- **PI 19**: "to imagine a language means to imagine a **form of life**" (Lebensform). - **Agreement in form of life, not in opinion** - shared *doing*; blocks relativist and intellectualist misreadings.
- **Lion remark**: too different a form of life -> no understanding even with speech. - **Bedrock**: "This is simply what I do"; forms of life are **"the given."**
- 2022 anomaly: printed **"motion"** for "notion" - retain and note.

RN-6 - Rule-Following (PI 201)

- **Paradox**: "no course of action could be determined by a rule, because every course of action can be made out to accord with the rule." - **Regress**: a rule to fix the rule needs its own rule - forever. - **Resolution**: grasping a rule is **"not an interpretation"** but is **exhibited in obeying** - a **practice/custom** grounded in training and form of life; normativity survives. - **Interpretive flag (keep labelled)**: **Kripkenstein** = sceptical paradox + community "solution"; a *reading*, contested by Baker/Hacker.
- Bridge: public criterion of correctness -> **no private rule** -> **no private language**.

RN-7 - The Private-Language Argument

- Target = **logically private** language (sensations unknowable to others in principle) - NOT a code, NOT soliloquy. - **Diary 258**: naming "S" has no independent check of "same" -> "whatever seems right is right... we can't talk about 'right'." No possible mistake -> no meaning. - **Beetle 293**: the private object "drops out as irrelevant"; "the box might even be empty." Meaning = **public use**. - **Solipsism (2019)**: its critique **culminates in** the critique of private language - the private world cannot even be said.
- Does NOT deny inner life or claim "we can't know other minds."

RN-8 - Criteria vs Symptoms; Behaviourism

- **Criterion** = **grammatical** (meaning-constituting, **defeasible**); **symptom** = **inductive** (experience-correlated). Difference in **kind**, not degree. - **PI 580**: "an 'inner process' stands in need of **outward criteria**" - grammar of inner talk, not its denial. - **Anti-behaviourism (PI 304, 307-308)**: rejects the inner *object* as semantic foundation ("grammatical fiction"), not the inner life - "not a something, but not a nothing either." Defeasibility (pretence) means pain != pain-behaviour.
- **First-person avowal**: "It hurts" is an expression, not a criterion-based report (asymmetry).

RN-9 - Philosophy as Therapy

- **Diagnosis**: problems arise when "**language goes on holiday**"; philosophy is "a battle against the **bewitchment** of our intelligence by means of language" (PI 109). - **Positive tool**: **perspicuous / surveyable representation** (PI 122, *übersichtliche Darstellung*) - "see connexions."
- **Aim**: "to show the fly the way out of the **fly-bottle**" (PI 309) - **dissolve**, not solve. - **Quietism**: "philosophy **leaves everything as it is**" (PI 124); no theses (PI 128); **different therapies**, not one method (PI 133).
- Objection/reply: "no theses" looks self-refuting -> reminders, not metaphysics; success = intellectual peace.

RN-10 - Aspect-Seeing / Duck-Rabbit

- **Duck-rabbit** (Jastrow; **PI Part II xi / PPF**): same marks, different **aspect**; the switch = **dawning of an aspect**; limit case = **aspect-blindness**. - Seeing-as is "**like seeing, and again not like seeing**" - **not** an interpretation/inference; it is experienced. - Payload: perception is **technique-laden** - the mastery behind meaning-as-use reaches into how we see (anti-empiricist about "bare data + interpretation"). - Provenance: cite **PPF / Part II xi**, credit **Jastrow**; not a numbered Part I remark.

RN-P - Provenance and Translation Discipline (earns marks)

- *Investigations* = **posthumous, 1953**, ed. **G. E. M. Anscombe and Rush Rhees**, trans. **Anscombe** (Wittgenstein d. 1951). Never write "Wittgenstein published the Investigations."
- *Tractatus* = 1921 (German) / 1922 (English).
- Keep **PI 43** hedge verbatim: "for a large class of cases - though not for all."
- "Perspicuous / surveyable representation" translates *übersichtliche Darstellung* (PI 122) - flag the translation variance.
- Duck-rabbit sits in **PPF (Part II xi)**; do not cite it as a numbered Part I remark. - **Kripkenstein** is a *reading of* Wittgenstein (community/sceptical solution), not his own doctrine - keep labelled.

RN-R - PYQ Routing (exactly 7 owned parts, 2018-2025)

- **2018 Q1(c), 10:** family resemblance upholds "language is a game" -> RN-3 (+ RN-4). - **2019 Q3(b), 15:** solipsism culminates in the private-language critique -> RN-7 (+ RN-6, RN-8). - **2020 Q4(c), 15:** could there be a language for one's private use? Answer + critique -> RN-7 + RN-8. - **2022 Q1(c), 10:** language as **form of life** (printed "motion" = "notion") -> RN-5. - **2023 Q4(c), 15:** reasons for the shift picture -> use -> RN-1 + RN-2 (+ RN-9 close).
- **2024 Q1(d), 10:** why no essentially private language -> RN-7 (tight). - **2025 Q3(a), 20:** the transition, via the quoted statement (unmatched quote before "logical structure") -> RN-1 + RN-2 (+ RN-9, RN-10 reach). - **2021:** no owned part - do not invent one.